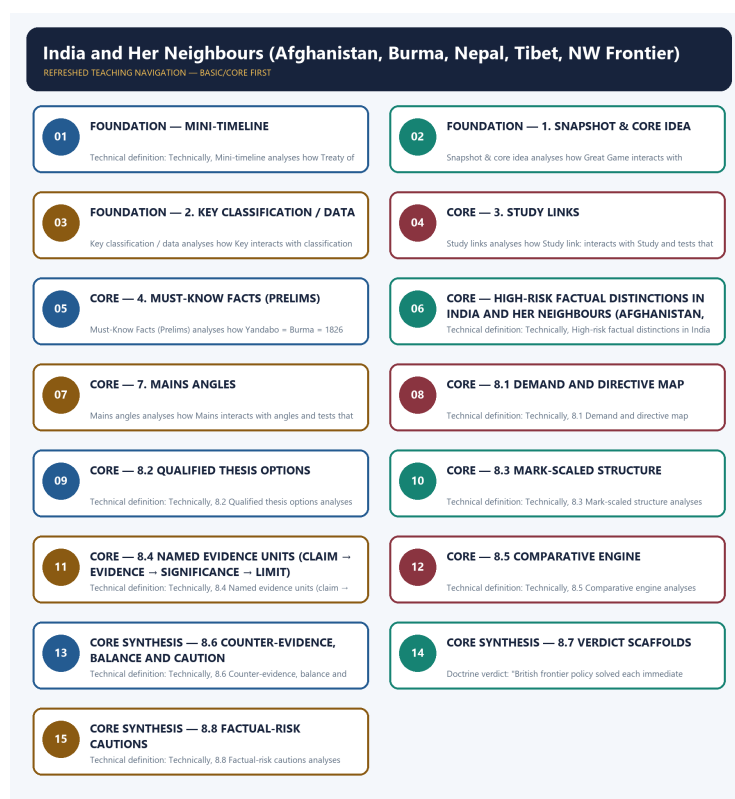


COMPLETE LEARNING SESSION

India and Her Neighbours (Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet, NW Frontier) - Learner-v2 Refreshed

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing



Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

CONTENTS / SESSION INDEX

Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

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India and Her Neighbours (Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet, NW Frontier) - Learner-v2 Complete Learning Session

SOURCE, PROGRESSION AND CURRENT-LINKAGE AUDIT

- **Repository owners queried:** Basic and Advanced Markdown for this topic, the master chronology, syllabus map and linked Modern History owners.
- **OCR book evidence queried:** OCR checks located the Treaty of Yandabo around PDF page 172, Gandamak around page 180 and Tibet/Younghusband around pages 180-183 of Bipan Chandra. These are cross-checked against the repository owner.
- **Qdrant:** not used; Markdown plus searchable local PDFs were sufficient.
- **PYQ integrity:** Repository routing audits assign no direct Modern-History PYQ to Topic 13. Geography and International Relations questions on current neighbours remain outside this owner's historical frontier-policy scope.
- **Bounded live linkage:** PIB's record of the July 2026 India-Myanmar national-level meeting is used only as a contemporary border-security and connectivity bridge. It is not evidence for nineteenth-century annexation, treaties or boundaries.
- **Fact/inference rule:** historical claims are source-backed; analytical judgements are explicitly framed as interpretation and do not invent figures.

BASIC LEARNING SESSION

DEEP-REVIEW LEARNING CONTRACT

Control	Binding rule for this package
Syllabus boundary	Complete Modern History Core is taught chronologically and causally before optional enrichment.
Evidence method	Claim -> named Act/treaty/record/organisation/person/region or scholarly evidence -> analysis -> qualification.
Date discipline	Event, proposal, enactment, commencement, official policy, implementation and later interpretation remain distinct.
Historiography	Colonial, nationalist, Marxist, subaltern, Cambridge, feminist and other relevant arguments are attributed and tested, never used as labels alone.
Practice contract	Every solved item has demand decoding, an examiner-grade model, an executable answer/compression plan, marks rationale and answer-specific improvement.
Approval	This immutable successor remains approved : false pending explicit approval.

Canonical Basic/Core owner:

upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Modern-Indian-History\basic\13_India-and-Her-Neighbours.md

Canonical topic owner:

upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Modern-Indian-History\basic\13_India-and-Her-Neighbours.md

Optional Advanced owner:

upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Modern-Indian-History\advanced\13_India-and-Her-Neighbours.md

Official syllabus mapping:

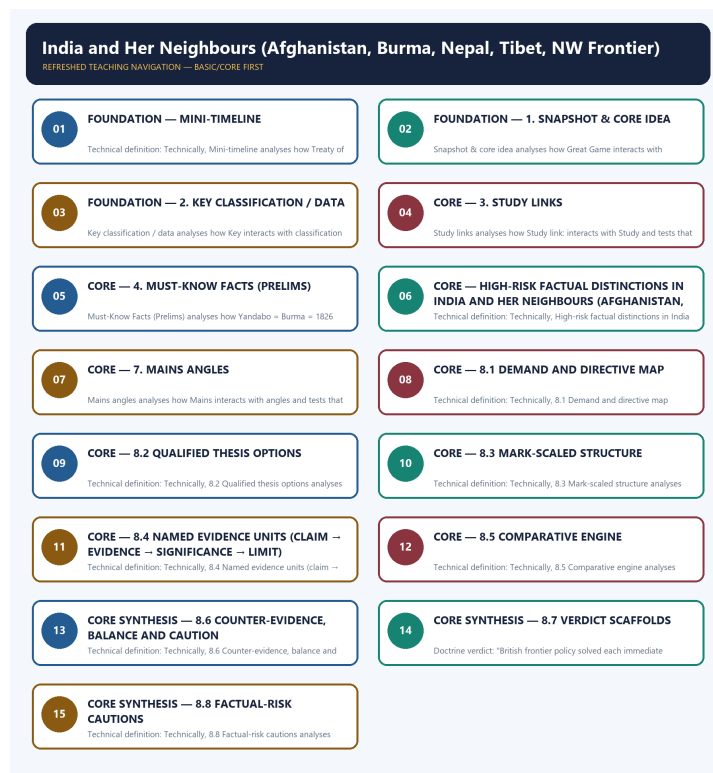
upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Modern-Indian-History\OFFICIAL-UPSC-SYLLABUS-MAPPING.md

EVIDENCE, PYQ AND CURRENT-STATUS CONTROL

- **Official and primary evidence:** Acts, charters, treaties, proclamations, committee reports, proceedings, organisational resolutions, speeches and contemporary records are dated and read for authorship and purpose.
- **Regional and social evidence:** petitions, newspapers, memoirs, local studies and material geography qualify elite or all-India generalisation.
- **Economic and quantitative evidence:** revenue, trade, price, wage, craft and mortality claims retain unit, region, period and uncertainty; statistics are never invented.
- **Scholarly interpretation:** historian schools are competing explanations tied to named evidence, not memorised verdicts.
- **PYQ discipline:** repository ledgers and locally held official papers control wording and metadata; reconstructed wording and unavailable official keys remain explicitly labelled.
- **Current-status note, rechecked 2026-09-04:** PIB's record of the July 2026 India-Myanmar national-level meeting is used only as a contemporary border-security and connectivity bridge. It is not evidence for nineteenth-century annexation, treaties or boundaries.

Live/primary context sources recorded by the predecessor generation:

- <https://pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2282625®=48&lang=1>



Refreshed teaching navigation

Distinct embedded teaching-navigation image. The separate continuous Cārvāka-style flowchart package remains an independent at-a-glance artifact.

SESSION 1 - FOUNDATION - MINI-TIMELINE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Plain definition: Mini-timeline is a learner's map within India and Her Neighbours (Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet, NW Frontier) that groups Treaty of Sagauli, Treaty of Yandabo and Treaty of Gandamak.

Technical definition: Technical definition: Technically, Mini-timeline analyses how Treaty of Sagauli interacts with Treaty of Yandabo and tests that relationship through Treaty of Gandamak and Durand Line.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Plain definition: Mini-timeline is a learner's map within India and Her Neighbours (Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet, NW Frontier) that groups Treaty of Sagauli, Treaty of Yandabo and Treaty of Gandamak.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **FOUNDATION**
- **Mini-timeline**
- **Plain definition**
- **Technical definition**
- **Treaty of Sagauli**
- **Treaty of Yandabo**

How to use them: Frame the answer through FOUNDATION; define Mini-timeline, connect Plain definition with Technical definition to explain the mechanism, and use Treaty of Sagauli for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

MINI-TIMELINE

Treaty of Sagauli -> Treaty of Yandabo -> Treaty of Gandamak -> Durand Line
context -> evidence -> mechanism -> qualification -> UPSC judgement

The visual fixes the subtopic's evidence-to-judgement sequence before detail.

CONCEPT DEFINITIONS

- **Plain definition:** Mini-timeline is a learner's map within India and Her Neighbours (Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet, NW Frontier) that groups Treaty of Sagauli, Treaty of Yandabo and Treaty of Gandamak.
- **Technical definition:** Technically, Mini-timeline analyses how Treaty of Sagauli interacts with Treaty of Yandabo and tests that relationship through Treaty of Gandamak and Durand Line.

Date	Event
FACT: 1814-16	Anglo-Nepalese War; Treaty of Sagauli
FACT: 1824-26	First Anglo-Burmese War; Treaty of Yandabo
FACT: 1839-42	First Anglo-Afghan War; retreat from Kabul exposed frontier disaster
FACT: 1852	Second Anglo-Burmese War; Lower Burma annexed under Dalhousie
FACT: 1878-80	Second Anglo-Afghan War; Treaty of Gandamak
FACT: 1885	Third Anglo-Burmese War; Upper Burma annexed under Dufferin
FACT: 1893	Durand Line agreement fixed Afghan frontier sphere
FACT: 1901	NWFP created under Curzon
FACT: 1904	Younghusband Mission reached Tibet; Lhasa Convention followed

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** preserve the exact actor-date-institution match and eliminate category errors.
- **Mains:** connect evidence to mechanism, add one limitation and end with a graded verdict.

MINI RECAP

- Retain the distinction expressed by **Mini-timeline**; do not reduce it to an isolated fact.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - FOUNDATION - MINI-TIMELINE

START / CONCEPT: FOUNDATION - Mini-timeline

|

v

EXACT TERMS: FOUNDATION · Mini-timeline · Plain definition · Technical definition · Treaty of Sagauli · Treaty of Yandabo

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Technical definition: Technically, Mini-timeline analyses how Treaty of Sagauli interacts with Treaty of Yandabo and tests that relationship through Treaty of Gandamak and Durand Line.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Retain the distinction expressed by Mini-timeline; do not reduce it to an isolated fact.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: retain the distinction expressed by Mini-timeline.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Plain definition: Mini-timeline is a learner's map within India and Her Neighbours (Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet, NW Frontier) that groups Treaty of Sagauli, Treaty of Yandabo and Treaty of Gandamak.

SESSION 2 - FOUNDATION - 1. SNAPSHOT & CORE IDEA

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Snapshot & core idea is a learner's map within India and Her Neighbours (Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet, NW Frontier) that groups Great Game, close-border policy and forward policy.

Technical definition: Snapshot & core idea analyses how Great Game interacts with close-border policy and tests that relationship through forward policy and 1824-26.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Snapshot & core idea is a learner's map within India and Her Neighbours (Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet, NW Frontier) that groups Great Game, close-border policy and forward policy.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- FOUNDATION
- Plain definition
- Technical definition
- Great Game
- close-border policy
- 1. Snapshot & core idea

How to use them: Frame the answer through FOUNDATION; define Plain definition, connect Technical definition with Great Game to explain the mechanism, and use close-border policy for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

1. SNAPSHOT & CORE IDEA

Great Game -> close-border policy -> forward policy -> 1824-26
context -> evidence -> mechanism -> qualification -> UPSC judgement

The visual fixes the subtopic's evidence-to-judgement sequence before detail.

CONCEPT DEFINITIONS

- **Plain definition:** 1. Snapshot & core idea is a learner's map within India and Her Neighbours (Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet, NW Frontier) that groups Great Game, close-border policy and forward policy.
- **Technical definition:** Technically, 1. Snapshot & core idea analyses how Great Game interacts with close-border policy and tests that relationship through forward policy and 1824-26.

Foundation - frontier policy aimed at security, buffers and imperial prestige.

- **FACT:** British rulers treated India's neighbours as part of a defensive ring around the empire.
- **FACT:** Afghanistan became central because of fear of Russian advance in Central Asia, often called the **Great Game**.
- **FACT:** The British alternated between **close-border policy** and **forward policy** on the north-west frontier.
- **FACT:** Buffer states and treaties were used to keep rival European power away from India's land frontiers.

Foundation - Burma, Nepal and Tibet were tied to imperial strategy.

- **FACT:** In Burma, the British fought three wars: **1824-26**, **1852** and **1885**, annexing territory in stages until Upper Burma was absorbed.
- **FACT:** In Nepal, the **Treaty of Sagauli (1816)** followed the Anglo-Nepalese War and led to a British Residency and Gurkha recruitment.
- **FACT:** In Tibet, Curzon sent the **Younghusband Mission (1904)**, producing the Lhasa Convention.
- **ANALYSIS:** Frontier policy also shaped later boundary problems and strategic anxieties after 1947.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** preserve the exact actor-date-institution match and eliminate category errors.
- **Mains:** connect evidence to mechanism, add one limitation and end with a graded verdict.

MINI RECAP

- Retain the distinction expressed by **1. Snapshot & core idea**; do not reduce it to an isolated fact.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - FOUNDATION - 1. SNAPSHOT & CORE IDEA

START / CONCEPT: FOUNDATION - 1. Snapshot & core idea

|

v

EXACT TERMS: FOUNDATION · Plain definition · Technical definition · Great Game · close-border policy · 1. Snapshot & core idea

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Snapshot & core idea analyses how Great Game interacts with close-border policy and tests that relationship through forward policy and 1824-26.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Snapshot & core idea; do not reduce it to an isolated fact.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: foundation - Burma, Nepal and Tibet were tied to imperial strategy.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Snapshot & core idea is a learner's map within India and Her Neighbours (Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet, NW Frontier) that groups Great Game, close-border policy and forward policy.

SESSION 3 - FOUNDATION - 2. KEY CLASSIFICATION / DATA

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Key classification / data is a learner's map within India and Her Neighbours (Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet, NW Frontier) that groups Key, classification and data.

Technical definition: Key classification / data analyses how Key interacts with classification and tests that relationship through data and context.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Key classification / data is a learner's map within India and Her Neighbours (Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet, NW Frontier) that groups Key, classification and data.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- FOUNDATION
- Plain definition
- Technical definition
- FACT: Afghanistan
- Great Game, buffer policy, forward policy
- 2. Key classification / data

How to use them: Frame the answer through FOUNDATION; define Plain definition, connect Technical definition with FACT: Afghanistan to explain the mechanism, and use Great Game, buffer policy, forward policy for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

2. KEY CLASSIFICATION / DATA

Key -> classification -> data

context -> evidence -> mechanism -> qualification -> UPSC judgement

The visual fixes the subtopic's evidence-to-judgement sequence before detail.

CONCEPT DEFINITIONS

- **Plain definition:** 2. Key classification / data is a learner's map within India and Her Neighbours (Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet, NW Frontier) that groups Key, classification and data.
- **Technical definition:** Technically, 2. Key classification / data analyses how Key interacts with classification and tests that relationship through data and context.

Region	Event / treaty	UPSC hook
FACT: Afghanistan	First Anglo-Afghan War 1839-42; Second 1878-80; Treaty of Gandamak	Great Game, buffer policy, forward policy
FACT: North-West Frontier	Close-border vs forward policy; NWFP 1901	Tribal frontier management under Curzon
FACT: Burma	Yandabo 1826; Lower Burma 1852; Upper Burma 1885	Burma part of India until 1937
FACT: Nepal	Anglo-Nepalese War 1814-16; Treaty of Sagauli	Gurkha recruitment and Residency
FACT: Tibet	Younghusband Mission 1904; Lhasa Convention	Curzon's frontier activism
FACT: Sikkim & Bhutan	Treaties and protectorate-style influence	Himalayan buffer strategy
ANALYSIS: Princely states	Paramountcy	Internal buffer and indirect control

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** preserve the exact actor-date-institution match and eliminate category errors.

- **Mains:** connect evidence to mechanism, add one limitation and end with a graded verdict.

MINI RECAP

- Retain the distinction expressed by **2. Key classification / data**; do not reduce it to an isolated fact.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - FOUNDATION - 2. KEY CLASSIFICATION / DATA

```

START / CONCEPT: FOUNDATION - 2. Key classification / data
|
v
EXACT TERMS: FOUNDATION • Plain definition • Technical definition • FACT: Afghanistan • Great Game,
buffer policy, forward policy • 2. Key classification / data
|
v
MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Key classification / data analyses how Key interacts with classification and
tests that relationship through data and context.
|
v
CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Key classification / data; do not reduce it to an isolated fact.
|
v
UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: do not reduce it to an isolated fact.
|
v
ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Key classification / data is a learner's map within India and Her
Neighbours (Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet, NW Frontier) that groups Key, classification and data.

```

SESSION 4 - CORE - 3. STUDY LINKS

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Study links is a learner's map within India and Her Neighbours (Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet, NW Frontier) that groups Study link:, Study and links.

Technical definition: Study links analyses how Study link: interacts with Study and tests that relationship through links and context.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Study links is a learner's map within India and Her Neighbours (Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet, NW Frontier) that groups Study link:, Study and links.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **Plain definition**
- **Technical definition**
- **Study link**
- **Study links**
- **Study**
- **3. Study links**

How to use them: Frame the answer through Plain definition; define Technical definition, connect Study link with Study links to explain the mechanism, and use Study for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

3. STUDY LINKS

Study link: -> Study -> links

context -> evidence -> mechanism -> qualification -> UPSC judgement

The visual fixes the subtopic's evidence-to-judgement sequence before detail.

CONCEPT DEFINITIONS

- **Plain definition:** 3. Study links is a learner's map within India and Her Neighbours (Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet, NW Frontier) that groups Study link:, Study and links.
- **Technical definition:** Technically, 3. Study links analyses how Study link: interacts with Study and tests that relationship through links and context.

Study link: FACT: British expansion methods and annexations ->

basic/05_British-Territorial-Expansion.md. **Study link:** FACT: Crown-era administration and Curzon's imperial state -> basic/12_Administrative-Changes-After-1858.md. **Study link:** ANALYSIS: Later international borders and integration issues -> basic/28_Integration-of-Princely-States.md.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** preserve the exact actor-date-institution match and eliminate category errors.
- **Mains:** connect evidence to mechanism, add one limitation and end with a graded verdict.

MINI RECAP

- Retain the distinction expressed by **3. Study links**; do not reduce it to an isolated fact.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - 3. STUDY LINKS

START / CONCEPT: CORE - 3. Study links

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Plain definition · Technical definition · Study link · Study links · Study · 3. Study links

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Study links analyses how Study link: interacts with Study and tests that relationship through links and context.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Study links; do not reduce it to an isolated fact.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: do not reduce it to an isolated fact.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Study links is a learner's map within India and Her Neighbours (Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet, NW Frontier) that groups Study link:, Study and links.

SESSION 5 - CORE - 4. MUST-KNOW FACTS (PRELIMS)

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Must-Know Facts (Prelims) is a learner's map within India and Her Neighbours (Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet, NW Frontier) that groups Yandabo = Burma = 1826, Sagauli = Nepal = 1816 and Gandamak = Afghanistan = 1879.

Technical definition: Must-Know Facts (Prelims) analyses how Yandabo = Burma = 1826 interacts with Sagauli = Nepal = 1816 and tests that relationship through Gandamak = Afghanistan = 1879 and Durand Line = 1893.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Must-Know Facts (Prelims) is a learner's map within India and Her Neighbours (Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet, NW Frontier) that groups Yandabo = Burma = 1826, Sagauli = Nepal = 1816 and Gandamak = Afghanistan = 1879.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Plain definition
- Technical definition
- Yandabo = Burma = 1826
- Sagauli = Nepal = 1816
- Gandamak = Afghanistan = 1879
- 4. Must-Know Facts (Prelims)

How to use them: Frame the answer through Plain definition; define Technical definition, connect Yandabo = Burma = 1826 with Sagauli = Nepal = 1816 to explain the mechanism, and use Gandamak = Afghanistan = 1879 for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

4. MUST-KNOW FACTS (PRELIMS)

Yandabo = Burma = 1826 -> Sagauli = Nepal = 1816 -> Gandamak = Afghanistan = 1879 -> Durand Line = 1893
context -> evidence -> mechanism -> qualification -> UPSC judgement

The visual fixes the subtopic's evidence-to-judgement sequence before detail.

CONCEPT DEFINITIONS

- **Plain definition:** 4. Must-Know Facts (Prelims) is a learner's map within India and Her Neighbours (Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet, NW Frontier) that groups Yandabo = Burma = 1826, Sagauli = Nepal = 1816 and Gandamak = Afghanistan = 1879.
- **Technical definition:** Technically, 4. Must-Know Facts (Prelims) analyses how Yandabo = Burma = 1826 interacts with Sagauli = Nepal = 1816 and tests that relationship through Gandamak = Afghanistan = 1879 and Durand Line = 1893.
- **FACT: Yandabo = Burma = 1826;** do not confuse it with Nepal or Afghanistan.
- **FACT: Sagauli = Nepal = 1816;** it followed the Anglo-Nepalese War.
- **FACT: Gandamak = Afghanistan = 1879;** it followed the Second Anglo-Afghan War.
- **FACT: Durand Line = 1893;** linked to the Afghan frontier.
- **FACT: NWFP = 1901 = Curzon.**
- **FACT: Burma was administered as part of India until 1937.**
- **FACT: Younghusband Mission = Tibet = 1904 = Curzon.**

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** preserve the exact actor-date-institution match and eliminate category errors.
- **Mains:** connect evidence to mechanism, add one limitation and end with a graded verdict.

MINI RECAP

- Retain the distinction expressed by **4. Must-Know Facts (Prelims)**; do not reduce it to an isolated fact.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - 4. MUST-KNOW FACTS (PRELIMS)

START / CONCEPT: CORE - 4. Must-Know Facts (Prelims)

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Plain definition · Technical definition · Yandabo = Burma = 1826 · Sagauli = Nepal = 1816 · Gandamak = Afghanistan = 1879 · 4. Must-Know Facts (Prelims)

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Must-Know Facts (Prelims) analyses how Yandabo = Burma = 1826 interacts with Sagauli = Nepal = 1816 and tests that relationship through Gandamak = Afghanistan = 1879 and Durand Line = 1893.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Must-Know Facts (Prelims); do not reduce it to an isolated fact.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: FACT: Yandabo = Burma = 1826; do not confuse it with Nepal or Afghanistan. FACT: Sagauli = Nepal = 1816; it followed the Anglo-Nepalese War. FACT: Gandamak = Afghanistan = 1879; it followed the Second Anglo-Afghan War. FACT: Durand Line = 1893; linked to the Afghan frontier. FACT: NWFP = 1901 = Curzon. FACT: Burma was administered as part of India until 1937. FACT: Younghusband Mission = Tibet = 1904 = Curzon.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Must-Know Facts (Prelims) is a learner's map within India and Her Neighbours (Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet, NW Frontier) that groups Yandabo = Burma = 1826, Sagauli = Nepal = 1816 and Gandamak = Afghanistan = 1879.

SESSION 6 - CORE - HIGH-RISK FACTUAL DISTINCTIONS IN INDIA AND HER NEIGHBOURS (AFGHANISTAN, BURMA, NEPAL, TIBET, NW FRONTIER)

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Plain definition: High-risk factual distinctions in India and Her Neighbours (Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet, NW Frontier) is a learner's map within India and Her Neighbours (Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet, NW Frontier) that groups war -> treaty -> region -> date, Burma and Nepal.

Technical definition: Technical definition: Technically, High-risk factual distinctions in India and Her Neighbours (Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet, NW Frontier) analyses how war -> treaty -> region -> date interacts with Burma and tests that relationship through Nepal and Afghanistan.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Retain the distinction expressed by High-risk factual distinctions in India and Her Neighbours (Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet, NW Frontier); do not reduce it to an isolated fact.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- High-risk factual distinctions in India
- Her Neighbours (Afghanistan
- Burma
- Nepal
- Tibet
- NW Frontier)

How to use them: Frame the answer through High-risk factual distinctions in India; define Her Neighbours (Afghanistan, connect Burma with Nepal to explain the mechanism, and use Tibet for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

HIGH-RISK FACTUAL DISTINCTIONS IN INDIA AND HER NEIGHBOURS (AFGHANISTAN, BURMA, NEPAL, TIBET, NW FRONTIER)

war -> treaty -> region -> date -> Burma -> Nepal -> Afghanistan

context -> evidence -> mechanism -> qualification -> UPSC judgement

The visual fixes the subtopic's evidence-to-judgement sequence before detail.

CONCEPT DEFINITIONS

- **Plain definition:** High-risk factual distinctions in India and Her Neighbours (Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet, NW Frontier) is a learner's map within India and Her Neighbours (Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet, NW Frontier) that groups war -> treaty -> region -> date, Burma and Nepal.
- **Technical definition:** Technically, High-risk factual distinctions in India and Her Neighbours (Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet, NW Frontier) analyses how war -> treaty -> region -> date interacts with Burma and tests that relationship through Nepal and Afghanistan.

MEMORY: Trap: Match **war -> treaty -> region -> date**; frontier questions are often date-and-treaty traps.

- WRONG: Treaty of Yandabo belongs to Nepal. -> It belongs to **Burma**.
- WRONG: Treaty of Sagauli belongs to Afghanistan. -> It belongs to **Nepal**.
- WRONG: Treaty of Gandamak belongs to Burma. -> It belongs to **Afghanistan**.
- WRONG: Burma was always separate from British India. -> It was administered as part of India until **1937**.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** preserve the exact actor-date-institution match and eliminate category errors.
- **Mains:** connect evidence to mechanism, add one limitation and end with a graded verdict.

MINI RECAP

- Retain the distinction expressed by **High-risk factual distinctions in India and Her Neighbours (Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet, NW Frontier)**; do not reduce it to an isolated fact.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - HIGH-RISK FACTUAL DISTINCTIONS IN INDIA AND HER NEIGHBOURS (AFGHANISTAN, BURMA, NEPAL, TIBET, NW FRONTIER)

START / CONCEPT: CORE - High-risk factual distinctions in India and Her Neighbours (Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet, NW Frontier)

|
v

EXACT TERMS: High-risk factual distinctions in India · Her Neighbours (Afghanistan · Burma · Nepal · Tibet · NW Frontier)

|
v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Technical definition: Technically, High-risk factual distinctions in India and Her Neighbours (Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet, NW Frontier) analyses how war -> treaty -> region -> date interacts with Burma and tests that relationship through Nepal and Afghanistan.

|
v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Plain definition: High-risk factual distinctions in India and Her Neighbours (Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet, NW Frontier) is a learner's map within India and Her Neighbours (Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet, NW Frontier) that groups war -> treaty -> region -> date, Burma and Nepal.

|
v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: WRONG: Treaty of Yandabo belongs to Nepal. -> It belongs to Burma. WRONG: Treaty...

|
v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Retain the distinction expressed by High-risk factual distinctions in India and Her Neighbours (Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet, NW Frontier); do not reduce it to an isolated fact.

CORE - 6. CURRENT: Current link

VISUAL FIRST

6. CURRENT: CURRENT LINK

Current -> link

context -> evidence -> mechanism -> qualification -> UPSC judgement

The visual fixes the subtopic's evidence-to-judgement sequence before detail.

CONCEPT DEFINITIONS

- **Plain definition:** 6. CURRENT: Current link is a learner's map within India and Her Neighbours (Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet, NW Frontier) that groups Current, link and context.
- **Technical definition:** Technically, 6. CURRENT: Current link analyses how Current interacts with link and tests that relationship through context and evidence.
- **ANALYSIS: Border management and neighbourhood-policy debates.** Colonial frontier lines and buffer policies remain useful background for modern discussions on Afghanistan, Myanmar and Himalayan borders. (*Escalate to CURRENT: when pegged to a verified news item.*)

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** preserve the exact actor-date-institution match and eliminate category errors.
- **Mains:** connect evidence to mechanism, add one limitation and end with a graded verdict.

MINI RECAP

- Retain the distinction expressed by **6. CURRENT: Current link**; do not reduce it to an isolated fact.

SESSION 7 - CORE - 7. MAINS ANGLES

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Mains angles is a learner's map within India and Her Neighbours (Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet, NW Frontier) that groups Mains, angles and context.

Technical definition: Mains angles analyses how Mains interacts with angles and tests that relationship through context and evidence.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Mains angles is a learner's map within India and Her Neighbours (Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet, NW Frontier) that groups Mains, angles and context.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **Plain definition**
- **Technical definition**
- **Mains angles**
- **India**
- **Her Neighbours**
- **7. Mains angles**

How to use them: Frame the answer through Plain definition; define Technical definition, connect Mains angles with India to explain the mechanism, and use Her Neighbours for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

7. MAINS ANGLES

Mains -> angles

context -> evidence -> mechanism -> qualification -> UPSC judgement

The visual fixes the subtopic's evidence-to-judgement sequence before detail.

CONCEPT DEFINITIONS

- **Plain definition:** 7. Mains angles is a learner's map within India and Her Neighbours (Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet, NW Frontier) that groups Mains, angles and context.
- **Technical definition:** Technically, 7. Mains angles analyses how Mains interacts with angles and tests that relationship through context and evidence.
- **ANALYSIS:** GS-1: Explain how British frontier policy combined fear of Russia, buffer states and forward policy.
- **ANALYSIS:** GS-1: Compare British policy towards Afghanistan and Burma in terms of security and expansion.
- **ANALYSIS:** GS-1: Assess the long-term legacy of colonial frontier-making for India's post-1947 neighbourhood.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** preserve the exact actor-date-institution match and eliminate category errors.
- **Mains:** connect evidence to mechanism, add one limitation and end with a graded verdict.

MINI RECAP

- Retain the distinction expressed by **7. Mains angles**; do not reduce it to an isolated fact.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - 7. MAINS ANGLES

START / CONCEPT: CORE - 7. Mains angles

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Plain definition • Technical definition • Mains angles • India • Her Neighbours • 7. Mains angles

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Mains angles analyses how Mains interacts with angles and tests that relationship through context and evidence.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Mains angles; do not reduce it to an isolated fact.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: explain how British frontier policy combined fear of Russia, buffer states and forward policy....

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Mains angles is a learner's map within India and Her Neighbours (Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet, NW Frontier) that groups Mains, angles and context.

CORE - Answer architecture overview

VISUAL FIRST

ANSWER ARCHITECTURE OVERVIEW

Answer -> architecture -> overview

context -> evidence -> mechanism -> qualification -> UPSC judgement

The visual fixes the subtopic's evidence-to-judgement sequence before detail.

CONCEPT DEFINITIONS

- **Plain definition:** Answer architecture overview is a learner's map within India and Her Neighbours (Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet, NW Frontier) that groups Answer, architecture and overview.
- **Technical definition:** Technically, Answer architecture overview analyses how Answer interacts with architecture and tests that relationship through overview and context.

Purpose: convert treaty-and-date material into answers on **strategic doctrine, comparison and legacy**, since this owner is examined more often through "why" and "with what consequence" than through narrative.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** preserve the exact actor-date-institution match and eliminate category errors.
- **Mains:** connect evidence to mechanism, add one limitation and end with a graded verdict.

MINI RECAP

- Retain the distinction expressed by **Answer architecture overview**; do not reduce it to an isolated fact.

SESSION 8 - CORE - 8.1 DEMAND AND DIRECTIVE MAP

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Plain definition: 8.1 Demand and directive map is a learner's map within India and Her Neighbours (Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet, NW Frontier) that groups Demand, and and directive.

Technical definition: Technical definition: Technically, 8.1 Demand and directive map analyses how Demand interacts with and and tests that relationship through directive and map.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Plain definition: 8.1 Demand and directive map is a learner's map within India and Her Neighbours (Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet, NW Frontier) that groups Demand, and and directive.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **directive map**
- **Plain definition**
- **Technical definition**
- **Doctrine analysis**
- **8.1 Demand**
- **8.1 Demand and directive map**

How to use them: Frame the answer through directive map; define Plain definition, connect Technical definition with Doctrine analysis to explain the mechanism, and use 8.1 Demand for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

8.1 DEMAND AND DIRECTIVE MAP

Demand -> and -> directive -> map

context -> evidence -> mechanism -> qualification -> UPSC judgement

The visual fixes the subtopic's evidence-to-judgement sequence before detail.

CONCEPT DEFINITIONS

- **Plain definition:** 8.1 Demand and directive map is a learner's map within India and Her Neighbours (Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet, NW Frontier) that groups Demand, and and directive.
- **Technical definition:** Technically, 8.1 Demand and directive map analyses how Demand interacts with and and tests that relationship through directive and map.

Demand family	Typical directive signals	Answer spine to use
Doctrine analysis	"Explain British frontier policy"	Threat perception -> doctrinal choice -> instrument -> cost
Comparison	"Compare policy toward Afghanistan and Burma"	Objective (buffer vs annexation) -> method -> outcome -> why they differed
Legacy	"Assess colonial frontier-making for India after 1947"	Line drawn -> state inherited -> dispute generated -> present significance
Cost/critique	"Was the forward policy justified?"	Security rationale -> military and fiscal cost -> Indian revenue burden
Economic motive	"Was frontier expansion strategic or commercial?"	Security argument -> commercial argument (Burma) -> weighting
Buffer logic	"Role of buffer states in imperial defence"	Ring of dependencies -> paramountcy -> limits

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** preserve the exact actor-date-institution match and eliminate category errors.
- **Mains:** connect evidence to mechanism, add one limitation and end with a graded verdict.

MINI RECAP

- Retain the distinction expressed by **8.1 Demand and directive map**; do not reduce it to an isolated fact.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - 8.1 DEMAND AND DIRECTIVE MAP

START / CONCEPT: CORE - 8.1 Demand and directive map

|

v

EXACT TERMS: directive map · Plain definition · Technical definition · Doctrine analysis · 8.1

Demand · 8.1 Demand and directive map

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Technical definition: Technically, 8.1 Demand and directive map analyses how Demand interacts with and and tests that relationship through directive and map.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Retain the distinction expressed by 8.1 Demand and directive map; do not reduce it to an isolated fact.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: retain the distinction expressed by 8.1 Demand and directive map.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Plain definition: 8.1 Demand and directive map is a learner's map within India and Her Neighbours (Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet, NW Frontier) that groups Demand, and and directive.

SESSION 9 - CORE - 8.2 QUALIFIED THESIS OPTIONS

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Plain definition: 8.2 Qualified thesis options is a learner's map within India and Her Neighbours (Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet, NW Frontier) that groups Threat-driven thesis:, Differentiated-objective thesis: and Cost thesis:.

Technical definition: Technical definition: Technically, 8.2 Qualified thesis options analyses how Threat-driven thesis: interacts with Differentiated-objective thesis: and tests that relationship through Cost thesis: and Legacy thesis:.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Plain definition: 8.2 Qualified thesis options is a learner's map within India and Her Neighbours (Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet, NW Frontier) that groups Threat-driven thesis:, Differentiated-objective thesis: and Cost thesis:.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Plain definition
- Technical definition
- Threat-driven thesis
- Differentiated-objective thesis
- Cost thesis
- 8.2 Qualified thesis options

How to use them: Frame the answer through Plain definition; define Technical definition, connect Threat-driven thesis with Differentiated-objective thesis to explain the mechanism, and use Cost thesis for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

8.2 QUALIFIED THESIS OPTIONS

Threat-driven thesis: -> Differentiated-objective thesis: -> Cost thesis: -> Legacy thesis:
context -> evidence -> mechanism -> qualification -> UPSC judgement

The visual fixes the subtopic's evidence-to-judgement sequence before detail.

CONCEPT DEFINITIONS

- **Plain definition:** 8.2 Qualified thesis options is a learner's map within India and Her Neighbours (Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet, NW Frontier) that groups Threat-driven thesis:, Differentiated-objective thesis: and Cost thesis:.
- **Technical definition:** Technically, 8.2 Qualified thesis options analyses how Threat-driven thesis: interacts with Differentiated-objective thesis: and tests that relationship through Cost thesis: and Legacy thesis:.
- **Threat-driven thesis:** *British frontier policy was defensive in conception and expansionist in effect: each measure taken to secure an existing border created a new frontier requiring further securing.*
- **Differentiated-objective thesis:** *The Raj did not have one neighbourhood policy but two - buffer management where a rival great power was involved (Afghanistan, Tibet, Nepal) and outright annexation where none was (Burma).*
- **Cost thesis:** *Frontier defence was paid for from Indian revenue for British imperial purposes, which is why "home charges plus frontier wars" became a standing item in the nationalist economic critique.*
- **Legacy thesis:** *Colonial frontier-making bequeathed independent India lines drawn for imperial convenience rather than for Indian security or ethnography, and the resulting boundary questions long outlived the empire that created them.*

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** preserve the exact actor-date-institution match and eliminate category errors.
- **Mains:** connect evidence to mechanism, add one limitation and end with a graded verdict.

MINI RECAP

- Retain the distinction expressed by **8.2 Qualified thesis options**; do not reduce it to an isolated fact.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - 8.2 QUALIFIED THESIS OPTIONS

START / CONCEPT: CORE - 8.2 Qualified thesis options

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Plain definition · Technical definition · Threat-driven thesis · Differentiated-objective thesis · Cost thesis · 8.2 Qualified thesis options

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Technical definition: Technically, 8.2 Qualified thesis options analyses how Threat-driven thesis: interacts with Differentiated-objective thesis: and tests that relationship through Cost thesis: and Legacy thesis:.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Retain the distinction expressed by 8.2 Qualified thesis options; do not reduce it to an isolated fact.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: british frontier policy was defensive in conception and expansionist in effect.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Plain definition: 8.2 Qualified thesis options is a learner's map within India and Her Neighbours (Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet, NW Frontier) that groups Threat-driven thesis:, Differentiated-objective thesis: and Cost thesis:.

SESSION 10 - CORE - 8.3 MARK-SCALED STRUCTURE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Plain definition: 8.3 Mark-scaled structure is a learner's map within India and Her Neighbours (Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet, NW Frontier) that groups Mark-scaled, structure and context.

Technical definition: Technical definition: Technically, 8.3 Mark-scaled structure analyses how Mark-scaled interacts with structure and tests that relationship through context and evidence.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Plain definition: 8.3 Mark-scaled structure is a learner's map within India and Her Neighbours (Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet, NW Frontier) that groups Mark-scaled, structure and context.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Plain definition
- Technical definition
- Thesis -> doctrine -> two theatres -> one cost -> verdict
- 8.3 Mark-scaled structure
- 3 treaties/lines with dates
- 5-6 units across three theatres

How to use them: Frame the answer through Plain definition; define Technical definition, connect Thesis -> doctrine -> two theatres -> one cost -> verdict with 8.3 Mark-scaled structure to explain the mechanism, and use 3 treaties/lines with dates for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

8.3 MARK-SCALED STRUCTURE

Mark-scaled -> structure

context -> evidence -> mechanism -> qualification -> UPSC judgement

The visual fixes the subtopic's evidence-to-judgement sequence before detail.

CONCEPT DEFINITIONS

- **Plain definition:** 8.3 Mark-scaled structure is a learner's map within India and Her Neighbours (Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet, NW Frontier) that groups Mark-scaled, structure and context.
- **Technical definition:** Technically, 8.3 Mark-scaled structure analyses how Mark-scaled interacts with structure and tests that relationship through context and evidence.

Marks	Recommended architecture	Evidence load
10	Thesis -> doctrine -> two theatres -> one cost -> verdict	3 treaties/lines with dates
15	Thesis -> Great Game logic -> Afghanistan -> Burma -> Himalayan belt -> costs -> verdict	5-6 units across three theatres
20	Thesis -> doctrine and its oscillation -> four theatres -> economic and political costs -> nationalist critique -> post-1947 legacy -> graded verdict	6-8 units including administrative arrangements, not only wars

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** preserve the exact actor-date-institution match and eliminate category errors.
- **Mains:** connect evidence to mechanism, add one limitation and end with a graded verdict.

MINI RECAP

- Retain the distinction expressed by **8.3 Mark-scaled structure**; do not reduce it to an isolated fact.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - 8.3 MARK-SCALED STRUCTURE

START / CONCEPT: CORE - 8.3 Mark-scaled structure

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Plain definition · Technical definition · Thesis -> doctrine -> two theatres -> one cost -> verdict · 8.3 Mark-scaled structure · 3 treaties/lines with dates · 5-6 units across three theatres

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Technical definition: Technically, 8.3 Mark-scaled structure analyses how Mark-scaled interacts with structure and tests that relationship through context and evidence.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Retain the distinction expressed by 8.3 Mark-scaled structure; do not reduce it to an isolated fact.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: retain the distinction expressed by 8.3 Mark-scaled structure.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Plain definition: 8.3 Mark-scaled structure is a learner's map within India and Her Neighbours (Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet, NW Frontier) that groups Mark-scaled, structure and context.

SESSION 11 - CORE - 8.4 NAMED EVIDENCE UNITS (CLAIM -> EVIDENCE -> SIGNIFICANCE -> LIMIT)

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Plain definition: 8.4 Named evidence units (claim -> evidence -> significance -> limit) is a learner's map within India and Her Neighbours (Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet, NW Frontier) that groups Claim:, Evidence: and close-border.

Technical definition: Technical definition: Technically, 8.4 Named evidence units (claim -> evidence -> significance -> limit) analyses how Claim: interacts with Evidence: and tests that relationship through close-border and forward.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Plain definition: 8.4 Named evidence units (claim -> evidence -> significance -> limit) is a learner's map within India and Her Neighbours (Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet, NW Frontier) that groups Claim:, Evidence: and close-border.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Plain definition
- Technical definition
- A. The Great Game and doctrinal oscillation
- Claim
- close-border
- 8.4 Named evidence units (claim -> evidence -> significance -> limit)

How to use them: Frame the answer through Plain definition; define Technical definition, connect A. The Great Game and doctrinal oscillation with Claim to explain the mechanism, and use close-border for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

8.4 NAMED EVIDENCE UNITS (CLAIM -> EVIDENCE -> SIGNIFICANCE -> LIMIT)
Claim: -> Evidence: -> close-border -> forward
context -> evidence -> mechanism -> qualification -> UPSC judgement

The visual fixes the subtopic's evidence-to-judgement sequence before detail.

CONCEPT DEFINITIONS

- **Plain definition:** 8.4 Named evidence units (claim -> evidence -> significance -> limit) is a learner's map within India and Her Neighbours (Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet, NW Frontier) that groups Claim:, Evidence: and close-border.
- **Technical definition:** Technically, 8.4 Named evidence units (claim -> evidence -> significance -> limit) analyses how Claim: interacts with Evidence: and tests that relationship through close-border and forward.

A. The Great Game and doctrinal oscillation

- **Claim:** Policy alternated because neither doctrine solved the underlying problem.
- **Evidence:** FACT: Fear of Russian advance in Central Asia drove Afghan policy; the British alternated between **close-border** and **forward** policy on the north-west frontier; FACT: **NWFP was created in 1901 under Curzon** as an administrative answer to tribal frontier management.
- **Significance:** The oscillation is the analytical content - a close border was cheap and left influence to rivals, a forward policy bought influence at the price of permanent tribal warfare.
- **Limit/caution:** Do not present the Russian threat as proven; it was a perception that shaped policy, and its realism was contested at the time.

B. Afghanistan - the buffer that had to be fought for

- **Claim:** Afghanistan was valued as a buffer, and each attempt to control it directly failed.

- **Evidence:** FACT: **First Anglo-Afghan War (1839-42)** ended in the disastrous retreat from Kabul; the **Second (1878-80)** produced the **Treaty of Gandamak (1879)**; the **Durand Line (1893)** fixed the frontier sphere.
- **Significance:** The pattern - intervention, reverse, negotiated buffer, boundary line - is the strongest evidence for the "defensive in conception, expansionist in effect" thesis.
- **Limit/caution:** Gandamak followed the **Second** war; do not attach it to the first or to the Durand agreement.

C. Burma - annexation, not buffering

- **Claim:** Where no European rival was engaged, security language gave way to commercial and territorial acquisition.
- **Evidence:** FACT: Three wars - **1824-26** (Treaty of **Yandabo**, 1826), **1852** (Lower Burma annexed under Dalhousie) and **1885** (Upper Burma annexed under Dufferin); FACT: **Burma was administered as part of India until 1937**.
- **Significance:** The staged, generation-by-generation absorption of a neighbouring kingdom is the clearest counter-case to the purely defensive reading of frontier policy, and Burma's administrative attachment explains later Indian migration, commerce and the 1937 separation.
- **Limit/caution:** Do not treat the 1937 separation as decolonisation; Burma remained a British possession.

D. The Himalayan belt - Nepal, Tibet, Sikkim, Bhutan

- **Claim:** The northern frontier was managed by treaty dependence rather than conquest.
- **Evidence:** FACT: The **Anglo-Nepalese War (1814-16)** and the **Treaty of Sagauli (1816)** brought a British Residency and **Gurkha recruitment**; FACT: Curzon's **Younghusband Mission (1904)** produced the **Lhasa Convention**; FACT: Sikkim and Bhutan were drawn into treaty and protectorate-style relationships.
- **Significance:** Gurkha recruitment converted a defeated adversary into a manpower source for the Indian Army - the most economically consequential outcome of the whole Himalayan policy - while the Tibet mission set precedents for boundary and status questions inherited in 1947.
- **Limit/caution:** Do not carry the Younghusband Mission's outcomes forward into modern boundary claims; note only that colonial-era arrangements framed later questions.

E. Cost and the nationalist critique

- **Claim:** Frontier policy is a bridge between this owner and colonial-economy arguments.
- **Evidence:** ANALYSIS: Frontier wars, the standing frontier garrison and the associated military expenditure were charged to **Indian revenue**, while the strategic benefit was imperial.
- **Significance:** Supplies the balance and critique paragraph - the analytical point that India paid for a defence perimeter defined by British rather than Indian interests.
- **Limit/caution:** Do not quantify military expenditure or its share of the budget; argue incidence, not amounts.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** preserve the exact actor-date-institution match and eliminate category errors.
- **Mains:** connect evidence to mechanism, add one limitation and end with a graded verdict.

MINI RECAP

- Retain the distinction expressed by **8.4 Named evidence units (claim -> evidence -> significance -> limit)**; do not reduce it to an isolated fact.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - 8.4 NAMED EVIDENCE UNITS (CLAIM -> EVIDENCE -> SIGNIFICANCE -> LIMIT)

START / CONCEPT: CORE - 8.4 Named evidence units (claim -> evidence -> significance -> limit)
|
v
EXACT TERMS: Plain definition · Technical definition · A. The Great Game and doctrinal oscillation
· Claim · close-border · 8.4 Named evidence units (claim -> evidence -> significance -> limit)
|
v
MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Technical definition: Technically, 8.4 Named evidence units (claim -> evidence -> significance -> limit) analyses how Claim: interacts with Evidence: and tests that relationship through close-border and forward.
|
v
CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Retain the distinction expressed by 8.4 Named evidence units (claim -> evidence -> significance -> limit); do not reduce it to an isolated fact.
|
v
UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Limit/caution: Do not carry the Younghusband Mission's outcomes forward into modern boundary claims; note only that colonial-era arrangements framed later questions.
|
v
ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Plain definition: 8.4 Named evidence units (claim -> evidence -> significance -> limit) is a learner's map within India and Her Neighbours (Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet, NW Frontier) that groups Claim:, Evidence: and close-border.

SESSION 12 - CORE - 8.5 COMPARATIVE ENGINE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Plain definition: 8.5 Comparative engine is a learner's map within India and Her Neighbours (Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet, NW Frontier) that groups Comparative, engine and context.

Technical definition: Technical definition: Technically, 8.5 Comparative engine analyses how Comparative interacts with engine and tests that relationship through context and evidence.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Plain definition: 8.5 Comparative engine is a learner's map within India and Her Neighbours (Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet, NW Frontier) that groups Comparative, engine and context.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Plain definition
- Technical definition
- Afghanistan
- Russian advance
- War, then buffer + boundary line
- 8.5 Comparative engine

How to use them: Frame the answer through Plain definition; define Technical definition, connect Afghanistan with Russian advance to explain the mechanism, and use War, then buffer + boundary line for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

8.5 COMPARATIVE ENGINE

Comparative -> engine

context -> evidence -> mechanism -> qualification -> UPSC judgement

The visual fixes the subtopic's evidence-to-judgement sequence before detail.

CONCEPT DEFINITIONS

- **Plain definition:** 8.5 Comparative engine is a learner's map within India and Her Neighbours (Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet, NW Frontier) that groups Comparative, engine and context.
- **Technical definition:** Technically, 8.5 Comparative engine analyses how Comparative interacts with engine and tests that relationship through context and evidence.

Theatre	Perceived threat	Instrument chosen	Outcome	Long shadow
Afghanistan	Russian advance	War, then buffer + boundary line	Independent buffer, Durand Line 1893	Frontier boundary questions
North-West Frontier	Tribal autonomy, porous border	Alternating close-border/forward policy; NWFP 1901	Permanent garrison and administrative exception	Frontier governance model
Burma	Commercial access, regional rivalry	Three wars and staged annexation	Full absorption, then 1937 separation	Migration, commerce, later boundary
Nepal	Post-war settlement	Treaty of Sagauli, Residency, recruitment	Treaty dependence with manpower gain	Enduring recruitment relationship
Tibet	Rival influence in Lhasa	Armed mission, convention	Temporary influence	Status and boundary questions

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** preserve the exact actor-date-institution match and eliminate category errors.
- **Mains:** connect evidence to mechanism, add one limitation and end with a graded verdict.

MINI RECAP

- Retain the distinction expressed by **8.5 Comparative engine**; do not reduce it to an isolated fact.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - 8.5 COMPARATIVE ENGINE

START / CONCEPT: CORE - 8.5 Comparative engine

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Plain definition · Technical definition · Afghanistan · Russian advance · War, then buffer + boundary line · 8.5 Comparative engine

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Technical definition: Technically, 8.5 Comparative engine analyses how Comparative interacts with engine and tests that relationship through context and evidence.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Retain the distinction expressed by 8.5 Comparative engine; do not reduce it to an isolated fact.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: retain the distinction expressed by 8.5 Comparative engine.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Plain definition: 8.5 Comparative engine is a learner's map within India and Her Neighbours (Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet, NW Frontier) that groups Comparative, engine and context.

SESSION 13 - CORE SYNTHESIS - 8.6 COUNTER-EVIDENCE, BALANCE AND CAUTION

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Plain definition: 8.6 Counter-evidence, balance and caution is a learner's map within India and Her Neighbours (Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet, NW Frontier) that groups Against pure aggression:, Against pure defence: and Regional variation:.

Technical definition: Technical definition: Technically, 8.6 Counter-evidence, balance and caution analyses how Against pure aggression: interacts with Against pure defence: and tests that relationship through Regional variation: and context.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Plain definition: 8.6 Counter-evidence, balance and caution is a learner's map within India and Her Neighbours (Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet, NW Frontier) that groups Against pure aggression:, Against pure defence: and Regional variation:.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **CORE SYNTHESIS**
- **balance**
- **caution**
- **Plain definition**
- **Technical definition**
- **8.6 Counter-evidence**

How to use them: Frame the answer through CORE SYNTHESIS; define balance, connect caution with Plain definition to explain the mechanism, and use Technical definition for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

8.6 COUNTER-EVIDENCE, BALANCE AND CAUTION

Against pure aggression: -> Against pure defence: -> Regional variation:
context -> evidence -> mechanism -> qualification -> UPSC judgement

The visual fixes the subtopic's evidence-to-judgement sequence before detail.

CONCEPT DEFINITIONS

- **Plain definition:** 8.6 Counter-evidence, balance and caution is a learner's map within India and Her Neighbours (Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet, NW Frontier) that groups Against pure aggression:, Against pure defence: and Regional variation:.
- **Technical definition:** Technically, 8.6 Counter-evidence, balance and caution analyses how Against pure aggression: interacts with Against pure defence: and tests that relationship through Regional variation: and context.
- **Against pure aggression:** several frontier arrangements were genuinely stabilising, and buffer policy avoided the far greater cost of occupying Afghanistan.
- **Against pure defence:** Burma's annexation and the forward policy periods show acquisitive motives operating under security language.
- **Regional variation:** the north-west was militarised, the north-east and Himalayan belt treaty-managed, and the eastern theatre annexed - one label does not cover all three.
- **ANALYSIS:** Treat "Great Game" as a conventional historical label rather than a contemporary official policy name.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** preserve the exact actor-date-institution match and eliminate category errors.
- **Mains:** connect evidence to mechanism, add one limitation and end with a graded verdict.

MINI RECAP

- Retain the distinction expressed by **8.6 Counter-evidence, balance and caution**; do not reduce it to an isolated fact.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE SYNTHESIS - 8.6 COUNTER-EVIDENCE, BALANCE AND CAUTION

START / CONCEPT: CORE SYNTHESIS - 8.6 Counter-evidence, balance and caution

|

v

EXACT TERMS: CORE SYNTHESIS · balance · caution · Plain definition · Technical definition · 8.6 Counter-evidence

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Technical definition: Technically, 8.6 Counter-evidence, balance and caution analyses how Against pure aggression: interacts with Against pure defence: and tests that relationship through Regional variation: and context.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Retain the distinction expressed by 8.6 Counter-evidence, balance and caution; do not reduce it to an isolated fact.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Regional variation: the north-west was militarised, the north-east and Himalayan belt treaty-managed, and the eastern theatre annexed - one label does not cover all three.

ANALYSIS: Treat "Great Game" as a conventional historical label rather than a contemporary official policy name.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Plain definition: 8.6 Counter-evidence, balance and caution is a learner's map within India and Her Neighbours (Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet, NW Frontier) that groups Against pure aggression:, Against pure defence: and Regional variation:.

SESSION 14 - CORE SYNTHESIS - 8.7 VERDICT SCAFFOLDS

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Plain definition: 8.7 Verdict scaffolds is a learner's map within India and Her Neighbours (Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet, NW Frontier) that groups Doctrine verdict:, Comparative verdict: and Legacy verdict:.

Technical definition: Doctrine verdict: "British frontier policy solved each immediate problem by creating the next one, which is why a defensive doctrine produced a century of expansion." Comparative verdict: "Where Britain faced a great power it built buffers; where it faced a kingdom it built provinces - the difference in method reveals the real hierarchy of motives." Legacy verdict: "Independent India inherited borders drawn to protect an empire, and had to defend them as a nation - the mismatch is the enduring cost of colonial frontier-making."

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Plain definition: 8.7 Verdict scaffolds is a learner's map within India and Her Neighbours (Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet, NW Frontier) that groups Doctrine verdict:, Comparative verdict: and Legacy verdict:.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **CORE SYNTHESIS**
- **Plain definition**
- **Technical definition**
- **Doctrine verdict**
- **Comparative verdict**
- **8.7 Verdict scaffolds**

How to use them: Frame the answer through CORE SYNTHESIS; define Plain definition, connect Technical definition with Doctrine verdict to explain the mechanism, and use Comparative verdict for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

8.7 VERDICT SCAFFOLDS

Doctrine verdict: -> Comparative verdict: -> Legacy verdict:
context -> evidence -> mechanism -> qualification -> UPSC judgement

The visual fixes the subtopic's evidence-to-judgement sequence before detail.

CONCEPT DEFINITIONS

- **Plain definition:** 8.7 Verdict scaffolds is a learner's map within India and Her Neighbours (Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet, NW Frontier) that groups Doctrine verdict:, Comparative verdict: and Legacy verdict:.
- **Technical definition:** Technically, 8.7 Verdict scaffolds analyses how Doctrine verdict: interacts with Comparative verdict: and tests that relationship through Legacy verdict: and context.
- **Doctrine verdict:** "British frontier policy solved each immediate problem by creating the next one, which is why a defensive doctrine produced a century of expansion."
- **Comparative verdict:** "Where Britain faced a great power it built buffers; where it faced a kingdom it built provinces - the difference in method reveals the real hierarchy of motives."
- **Legacy verdict:** "Independent India inherited borders drawn to protect an empire, and had to defend them as a nation - the mismatch is the enduring cost of colonial frontier-making."

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** preserve the exact actor-date-institution match and eliminate category errors.
- **Mains:** connect evidence to mechanism, add one limitation and end with a graded verdict.

MINI RECAP

- Retain the distinction expressed by **8.7 Verdict scaffolds**; do not reduce it to an isolated fact.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE SYNTHESIS - 8.7 VERDICT SCAFFOLDS

START / CONCEPT: CORE SYNTHESIS - 8.7 Verdict scaffolds

|
v

EXACT TERMS: CORE SYNTHESIS · Plain definition · Technical definition · Doctrine verdict ·
Comparative verdict · 8.7 Verdict scaffolds

|
v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Technical definition: Technically, 8.7 Verdict scaffolds analyses how
Doctrine verdict: interacts with Comparative verdict: and tests that relationship through Legacy
verdict: and context.

|
v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Retain the distinction expressed by 8.7 Verdict scaffolds; do not reduce it
to an isolated fact.

|
v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: "British frontier policy solved each
immediate problem by creating the next one, which is..."

|
v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Plain definition: 8.7 Verdict scaffolds is a learner's map within
India and Her Neighbours (Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet, NW Frontier) that groups Doctrine
verdict:, Comparative verdict: and Legacy verdict:.

SESSION 15 - CORE SYNTHESIS - 8.8 FACTUAL-RISK CAUTIONS

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Plain definition: 8.8 Factual-risk cautions is a learner's map within India and Her Neighbours (Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet, NW Frontier) that groups Yandabo (1826) = Burma, Sagauli (1816) = Nepal and Gandamak (1879) = Afghanistan.

Technical definition: Technical definition: Technically, 8.8 Factual-risk cautions analyses how Yandabo (1826) = Burma interacts with Sagauli (1816) = Nepal and tests that relationship through Gandamak (1879) = Afghanistan and 1893.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Plain definition: 8.8 Factual-risk cautions is a learner's map within India and Her Neighbours (Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet, NW Frontier) that groups Yandabo (1826) = Burma, Sagauli (1816) = Nepal and Gandamak (1879) = Afghanistan.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **CORE SYNTHESIS**
- **Plain definition**
- **Technical definition**
- **Yandabo (1826) = Burma**
- **Sagauli (1816) = Nepal**
- **8.8 Factual-risk cautions**

How to use them: Frame the answer through CORE SYNTHESIS; define Plain definition, connect Technical definition with Yandabo (1826) = Burma to explain the mechanism, and use Sagauli (1816) = Nepal for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

8.8 FACTUAL-RISK CAUTIONS

Yandabo (1826) = Burma -> Sagauli (1816) = Nepal -> Gandamak (1879) = Afghanistan -> 1893
context -> evidence -> mechanism -> qualification -> UPSC judgement

The visual fixes the subtopic's evidence-to-judgement sequence before detail.

CONCEPT DEFINITIONS

- **Plain definition:** 8.8 Factual-risk cautions is a learner's map within India and Her Neighbours (Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet, NW Frontier) that groups Yandabo (1826) = Burma, Sagauli (1816) = Nepal and Gandamak (1879) = Afghanistan.
- **Technical definition:** Technically, 8.8 Factual-risk cautions analyses how Yandabo (1826) = Burma interacts with Sagauli (1816) = Nepal and tests that relationship through Gandamak (1879) = Afghanistan and 1893.
- **Yandabo (1826) = Burma, Sagauli (1816) = Nepal, Gandamak (1879) = Afghanistan** - the standard treaty-region trap.
- Durand Line = **1893**; NWFP = **1901** (Curzon); Younghusband Mission = **1904** (Curzon).
- Lower Burma was annexed in **1852** (Dalhousie) and Upper Burma in **1885** (Dufferin).
- Burma remained part of British India until **1937**.
- Do not assert the modern legal status of any colonial-era boundary line; confine claims to the historical agreement and its date.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** preserve the exact actor-date-institution match and eliminate category errors.
- **Mains:** connect evidence to mechanism, add one limitation and end with a graded verdict.

MINI RECAP

- Retain the distinction expressed by **8.8 Factual-risk cautions**; do not reduce it to an isolated fact.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE SYNTHESIS - 8.8 FACTUAL-RISK CAUTIONS

START / CONCEPT: CORE SYNTHESIS - 8.8 Factual-risk cautions

|

v

EXACT TERMS: CORE SYNTHESIS · Plain definition · Technical definition · Yandabo (1826) = Burma · Sagauli (1816) = Nepal · 8.8 Factual-risk cautions

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Technical definition: Technically, 8.8 Factual-risk cautions analyses how Yandabo (1826) = Burma interacts with Sagauli (1816) = Nepal and tests that relationship through Gandamak (1879) = Afghanistan and 1893.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Retain the distinction expressed by 8.8 Factual-risk cautions; do not reduce it to an isolated fact.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not assert the modern legal status of any colonial-era boundary line; confine claims to the historical agreement and its date.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Plain definition: 8.8 Factual-risk cautions is a learner's map within India and Her Neighbours (Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet, NW Frontier) that groups Yandabo (1826) = Burma, Sagauli (1816) = Nepal and Gandamak (1879) = Afghanistan.

MODERN HISTORY DEEP-REVIEW CORE CONTROL

- **Must remember:** Keep the Afghan wars (1839-42, 1878-80, 1919), Burma wars (1824-26, 1852, 1885), Nepal war and Treaty of Sugauli (1814-16), and Younghusband mission to Tibet (1903-04) distinct.
- **Close distinction:** Forward policy, 'masterly inactivity', buffer strategy, annexation and frontier administration were debated and changed over time; modern boundaries cannot be projected backward.
- **Evidence / interpretation limit:** Imperial strategic writing must be checked against treaty texts, terrain, logistics and Afghan, Burmese, Nepali, Tibetan and frontier agency rather than reproducing a Great Game gaze.

TOPIC 13 CLOSING FRONTIER-AND-NEIGHBOURS LEDGER

Topic 13 owns British India's imperial foreign and frontier policy toward Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet and the North-West Frontier, including the strategic doctrines, war/treaty sequence, buffer-versus-annexation comparison, Indian-revenue burden and boundary-administration legacy. Topic 05 retains the general expansion-state mechanism; Topic 12 supplies Crown-era governance; post-1947 neighbourhood law and diplomacy remain outside this history owner.

There was no single frontier doctrine. Afghanistan moved through intervention, withdrawal, influence and boundary-making under the perceived Russian threat: First Anglo-Afghan War 1839-42; Second War 1878-80 and Gandamak 1879; Durand agreement 1893; Third War 1919 as a bounded endpoint. Close-border, masterly inactivity and forward-policy arguments changed with governors, intelligence, terrain and imperial confidence.

Burma followed a different annexation ladder: war and Yandabo in 1824-26, Lower Burma in 1852, Upper Burma in 1885, and administrative separation from India in 1937. Nepal's war of 1814-16 and Treaty of Sugauli/Sagauli produced treaty influence, Residency and Gurkha recruitment without annexation. Curzon's Younghusband expedition to Tibet in 1903-04 and the 1904 Lhasa Convention must not be confused with the Durand frontier.

Forward policy did not always mean annexation; a buffer was not independent of pressure; a treaty did not erase local agency. Afghan, Burmese, Nepali, Tibetan and frontier peoples acted within terrain and logistics that repeatedly limited imperial plans. Costs charged to Indian revenue connect this owner to economic nationalism without transferring the full drain argument here.

Repository routing for 2018-2026 assigns zero direct Modern-History PYQs to Topic 13. Current Geography and International Relations questions on neighbours remain outside this owner; all historical practice is original and labelled.

Answer: threat perception -> doctrine choice -> theatre-specific instrument -> war/treaty/administration -> local agency and logistical limit -> fiscal incidence -> buffer versus annexation comparison -> bounded legacy.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. Which statement correctly identifies Imperial defensive ring?

A. British India treated neighbouring states and frontier zones as a strategic ring around the Indian empire. B. The Great Game describes Anglo-Russian rivalry in Central Asia that shaped British policy toward Afghanistan. C. Close-border policy sought to defend settled limits without permanent advance into tribal or Afghan territory. D. Forward policy used missions, posts, subsidies, war and political control to pre-empt perceived rival influence.

Answer: A. Explanation: British India treated neighbouring states and frontier zones as a strategic ring around the Indian empire. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q2. Which chronology card should be filed under Imperial defensive ring?

A. Close-border policy sought to defend settled limits without permanent advance into tribal or Afghan territory. B. British India treated neighbouring states and frontier zones as a strategic ring around the Indian empire. C. The First Anglo-Afghan War of 1839-42 ended in a disastrous British retreat from Kabul. D. Forward policy used missions, posts, subsidies, war and political control to pre-empt perceived rival influence.

Answer: B. Explanation: British India treated neighbouring states and frontier zones as a strategic ring around the Indian empire. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q3. Which option should a candidate retain when revising Imperial defensive ring?

A. The Second Anglo-Afghan War of 1878-80 reflected Lytton's forward policy. B. The First Anglo-Afghan War of 1839-42 ended in a disastrous British retreat from Kabul. C. British India treated neighbouring states and frontier zones as a strategic ring around the Indian empire. D. Forward policy used missions, posts, subsidies, war and political control to pre-empt perceived rival influence.

Answer: C. Explanation: British India treated neighbouring states and frontier zones as a strategic ring around the Indian empire. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q4. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about Imperial defensive ring?

A. The Second Anglo-Afghan War of 1878-80 reflected Lytton's forward policy. B. The First Anglo-Afghan War of 1839-42 ended in a disastrous British retreat from Kabul. C. The Treaty of Gandamak of 1879 followed the Second Anglo-Afghan War and expanded British influence over Afghan external affairs. D. British India treated neighbouring states and frontier zones as a strategic ring around the Indian empire.

Answer: D. Explanation: British India treated neighbouring states and frontier zones as a strategic ring around the Indian empire. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q5. Which statement correctly identifies Great Game?

A. The Great Game describes Anglo-Russian rivalry in Central Asia that shaped British policy toward Afghanistan. B. Forward policy used missions, posts, subsidies, war and political control to pre-empt perceived rival influence. C. The First Anglo-Afghan War of 1839-42 ended in a disastrous British retreat from Kabul. D. Close-border policy sought to defend settled limits without permanent advance into tribal or Afghan territory.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Great Game describes Anglo-Russian rivalry in Central Asia that shaped British policy toward Afghanistan. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q6. Which chronology card should be filed under Great Game?

A. The First Anglo-Afghan War of 1839-42 ended in a disastrous British retreat from Kabul. B. The Great Game describes Anglo-Russian rivalry in Central Asia that shaped British policy toward Afghanistan. C. The Second Anglo-Afghan War of 1878-80 reflected Lytton's forward policy. D. Forward policy used missions, posts, subsidies, war and political control to pre-empt perceived rival influence.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Great Game describes Anglo-Russian rivalry in Central Asia that shaped British policy toward Afghanistan. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q7. Which option should a candidate retain when revising Great Game?

A. The First Anglo-Afghan War of 1839-42 ended in a disastrous British retreat from Kabul. B. The Second Anglo-Afghan War of 1878-80 reflected Lytton's forward policy. C. The Great Game describes Anglo-Russian rivalry in Central Asia that shaped British policy toward Afghanistan. D. The Treaty of Gandamak of 1879 followed the Second Anglo-Afghan War and expanded British influence over Afghan external affairs.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Great Game describes Anglo-Russian rivalry in Central Asia that shaped British policy toward Afghanistan. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q8. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about Great Game?

A. The Treaty of Gandamak of 1879 followed the Second Anglo-Afghan War and expanded British influence over Afghan external affairs. B. The Second Anglo-Afghan War of 1878-80 reflected Lytton's forward policy. C. The Durand agreement of 1893 marked the Afghan frontier sphere under colonial strategic pressure. D. The Great Game describes Anglo-Russian rivalry in Central Asia that shaped British policy toward Afghanistan.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Great Game describes Anglo-Russian rivalry in Central Asia that shaped British policy toward Afghanistan. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q9. Which statement correctly identifies Close-border policy?

A. Close-border policy sought to defend settled limits without permanent advance into tribal or Afghan territory. B. Forward policy used missions, posts, subsidies, war and political control to pre-empt perceived rival influence. C. The First Anglo-Afghan War of 1839-42 ended in a disastrous British retreat from Kabul. D. The Second Anglo-Afghan War of 1878-80 reflected Lytton's forward policy.

Answer: A. Explanation: Close-border policy sought to defend settled limits without permanent advance into tribal or Afghan territory. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q10. Which chronology card should be filed under Close-border policy?

A. The Treaty of Gandamak of 1879 followed the Second Anglo-Afghan War and expanded British influence over Afghan external affairs. B. Close-border policy sought to defend settled limits without permanent advance into tribal or Afghan territory. C. The Second Anglo-Afghan War of 1878-80 reflected Lytton's forward policy. D. The First Anglo-Afghan War of 1839-42 ended in a disastrous British retreat from Kabul.

Answer: B. Explanation: Close-border policy sought to defend settled limits without permanent advance into tribal or Afghan territory. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q11. Which option should a candidate retain when revising Close-border policy?

A. The Treaty of Gandamak of 1879 followed the Second Anglo-Afghan War and expanded British influence over Afghan external affairs. B. The Second Anglo-Afghan War of 1878-80 reflected Lytton's forward policy. C. Close-border policy sought to defend settled limits without permanent advance into tribal or Afghan territory. D. The Durand agreement of 1893 marked the Afghan frontier sphere under colonial strategic pressure.

Answer: C. Explanation: Close-border policy sought to defend settled limits without permanent advance into tribal or Afghan territory. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q12. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about Close-border policy?

A. The Durand agreement of 1893 marked the Afghan frontier sphere under colonial strategic pressure. B. Curzon created the North-West Frontier Province in 1901 as a special frontier administration. C. The Treaty of Gandamak of 1879 followed the Second Anglo-Afghan War and expanded British influence over Afghan external affairs. D. Close-border policy sought to defend settled limits without permanent advance into tribal or Afghan territory.

Answer: D. Explanation: Close-border policy sought to defend settled limits without permanent advance into tribal or Afghan territory. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q13. Which statement correctly identifies Forward policy?

A. Forward policy used missions, posts, subsidies, war and political control to pre-empt perceived rival influence. B. The Second Anglo-Afghan War of 1878-80 reflected Lytton's forward policy. C. The Treaty of Gandamak of 1879 followed the Second Anglo-Afghan War and expanded British influence over Afghan external affairs. D. The First Anglo-Afghan War of 1839-42 ended in a disastrous British retreat from Kabul.

Answer: A. Explanation: Forward policy used missions, posts, subsidies, war and political control to pre-empt perceived rival influence. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q14. Which chronology card should be filed under Forward policy?

A. The Second Anglo-Afghan War of 1878-80 reflected Lytton's forward policy. B. Forward policy used missions, posts, subsidies, war and political control to pre-empt perceived rival influence. C. The Treaty of Gandamak of 1879 followed the Second Anglo-Afghan War and expanded British influence over Afghan external affairs. D. The Durand agreement of 1893 marked the Afghan frontier sphere under colonial strategic pressure.

Answer: B. Explanation: Forward policy used missions, posts, subsidies, war and political control to pre-empt perceived rival influence. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q15. Which option should a candidate retain when revising Forward policy?

A. The Treaty of Gandamak of 1879 followed the Second Anglo-Afghan War and expanded British influence over Afghan external affairs. B. Curzon created the North-West Frontier Province in 1901 as a special frontier administration. C. Forward policy used missions, posts, subsidies, war and political control to pre-empt perceived rival influence. D. The Durand agreement of 1893 marked the Afghan frontier sphere under colonial strategic pressure.

Answer: C. Explanation: Forward policy used missions, posts, subsidies, war and political control to pre-empt perceived rival influence. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q16. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about Forward policy?

A. The Durand agreement of 1893 marked the Afghan frontier sphere under colonial strategic pressure. B. Curzon created the North-West Frontier Province in 1901 as a special frontier administration. C. The First Anglo-Burmese War of 1824-26 ended with the Treaty of Yandabo. D. Forward policy used missions, posts, subsidies, war and political control to pre-empt perceived rival influence.

Answer: D. Explanation: Forward policy used missions, posts, subsidies, war and political control to pre-empt perceived rival influence. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q17. Which statement correctly identifies First Anglo-Afghan War?

A. The First Anglo-Afghan War of 1839-42 ended in a disastrous British retreat from Kabul. B. The Treaty of Gandamak of 1879 followed the Second Anglo-Afghan War and expanded British influence over Afghan external affairs. C. The Durand agreement of 1893 marked the Afghan frontier sphere under colonial strategic pressure. D. The Second Anglo-Afghan War of 1878-80 reflected Lytton's forward policy.

Answer: A. Explanation: The First Anglo-Afghan War of 1839-42 ended in a disastrous British retreat from Kabul. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q18. Which chronology card should be filed under First Anglo-Afghan War?

A. Curzon created the North-West Frontier Province in 1901 as a special frontier administration. B. The First Anglo-Afghan War of 1839-42 ended in a disastrous British retreat from Kabul. C. The Treaty of Gandamak of 1879 followed the Second Anglo-Afghan War and expanded British influence over Afghan external affairs. D. The Durand agreement of 1893 marked the Afghan frontier sphere under colonial strategic pressure.

Answer: B. Explanation: The First Anglo-Afghan War of 1839-42 ended in a disastrous British retreat from Kabul. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q19. Which option should a candidate retain when revising First Anglo-Afghan War?

A. The First Anglo-Burmese War of 1824-26 ended with the Treaty of Yandabo. B. The Durand agreement of 1893 marked the Afghan frontier sphere under colonial strategic pressure. C. The First Anglo-Afghan War of 1839-42 ended in a disastrous British retreat from Kabul. D. Curzon created the North-West Frontier Province in 1901 as a special frontier administration.

Answer: C. Explanation: The First Anglo-Afghan War of 1839-42 ended in a disastrous British retreat from Kabul. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q20. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about First Anglo-Afghan War?

A. The First Anglo-Burmese War of 1824-26 ended with the Treaty of Yandabo. B. Curzon created the North-West Frontier Province in 1901 as a special frontier administration. C. The Second Anglo-Burmese War of 1852 led to the annexation of Lower Burma under Dalhousie. D. The First Anglo-Afghan War of 1839-42 ended in a disastrous British retreat from Kabul.

Answer: D. Explanation: The First Anglo-Afghan War of 1839-42 ended in a disastrous British retreat from Kabul. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q21. Which statement correctly identifies Second Anglo-Afghan War?

A. The Second Anglo-Afghan War of 1878-80 reflected Lytton's forward policy. B. The Durand agreement of 1893 marked the Afghan frontier sphere under colonial strategic pressure. C. Curzon created the North-West Frontier Province in 1901 as a special frontier administration. D. The Treaty of Gandamak of 1879 followed the Second Anglo-Afghan War and expanded British influence over Afghan external affairs.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Second Anglo-Afghan War of 1878-80 reflected Lytton's forward policy. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q22. Which chronology card should be filed under Second Anglo-Afghan War?

A. The Durand agreement of 1893 marked the Afghan frontier sphere under colonial strategic pressure. B. The Second Anglo-Afghan War of 1878-80 reflected Lytton's forward policy. C. Curzon created the North-West Frontier Province in 1901 as a special frontier administration. D. The First Anglo-Burmese War of 1824-26 ended with the Treaty of Yandabo.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Second Anglo-Afghan War of 1878-80 reflected Lytton's forward policy. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q23. Which option should a candidate retain when revising Second Anglo-Afghan War?

A. The Second Anglo-Burmese War of 1852 led to the annexation of Lower Burma under Dalhousie. B. Curzon created the North-West Frontier Province in 1901 as a special frontier administration. C. The Second Anglo-Afghan War of 1878-80 reflected Lytton's forward policy. D. The First Anglo-Burmese War of 1824-26 ended with the Treaty of Yandabo.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Second Anglo-Afghan War of 1878-80 reflected Lytton's forward policy. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q24. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about Second Anglo-Afghan War?

A. The First Anglo-Burmese War of 1824-26 ended with the Treaty of Yandabo. B. The Second Anglo-Burmese War of 1852 led to the annexation of Lower Burma under Dalhousie. C. The Third Anglo-Burmese War of 1885 led to the annexation of Upper Burma under Dufferin. D. The Second Anglo-Afghan War of 1878-80 reflected Lytton's forward policy.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Second Anglo-Afghan War of 1878-80 reflected Lytton's forward policy. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q25. Which statement correctly identifies Treaty of Gandamak?

A. The Treaty of Gandamak of 1879 followed the Second Anglo-Afghan War and expanded British influence over Afghan external affairs. B. The First Anglo-Burmese War of 1824-26 ended with the Treaty of Yandabo. C. The Durand agreement of 1893 marked the Afghan frontier sphere under colonial strategic pressure. D. Curzon created the North-West Frontier Province in 1901 as a special frontier administration.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Treaty of Gandamak of 1879 followed the Second Anglo-Afghan War and expanded British influence over Afghan external affairs. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q26. Which chronology card should be filed under Treaty of Gandamak?

A. The Second Anglo-Burmese War of 1852 led to the annexation of Lower Burma under Dalhousie. B. The Treaty of Gandamak of 1879 followed the Second Anglo-Afghan War and expanded British influence over Afghan external affairs. C. The First Anglo-Burmese War of 1824-26 ended with the Treaty of Yandabo. D. Curzon created the North-West Frontier Province in 1901 as a special frontier administration.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Treaty of Gandamak of 1879 followed the Second Anglo-Afghan War and expanded British influence over Afghan external affairs. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q27. Which option should a candidate retain when revising Treaty of Gandamak?

A. The First Anglo-Burmese War of 1824-26 ended with the Treaty of Yandabo. B. The Second Anglo-Burmese War of 1852 led to the annexation of Lower Burma under Dalhousie. C. The Treaty of Gandamak of 1879 followed the Second Anglo-Afghan War and expanded British influence over Afghan external affairs. D. The Third Anglo-Burmese War of 1885 led to the annexation of Upper Burma under Dufferin.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Treaty of Gandamak of 1879 followed the Second Anglo-Afghan War and expanded British influence over Afghan external affairs. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q28. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about Treaty of Gandamak?

A. The Third Anglo-Burmese War of 1885 led to the annexation of Upper Burma under Dufferin. B. Burma remained administratively part of British India until its separation in 1937. C. The Second Anglo-Burmese War of 1852 led to the annexation of Lower Burma under Dalhousie. D. The Treaty of Gandamak of 1879 followed the Second Anglo-Afghan War and expanded British influence over Afghan external affairs.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Treaty of Gandamak of 1879 followed the Second Anglo-Afghan War and expanded British influence over Afghan external affairs. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q29. Which statement correctly identifies Durand Line?

A. The Durand agreement of 1893 marked the Afghan frontier sphere under colonial strategic pressure. B. The First Anglo-Burmese War of 1824-26 ended with the Treaty of Yandabo. C. The Second Anglo-Burmese War of 1852 led to the annexation of Lower Burma under Dalhousie. D. Curzon created the North-West Frontier Province in 1901 as a special frontier administration.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Durand agreement of 1893 marked the Afghan frontier sphere under colonial strategic pressure. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q30. Which chronology card should be filed under Durand Line?

A. The First Anglo-Burmese War of 1824-26 ended with the Treaty of Yandabo. B. The Durand agreement of 1893 marked the Afghan frontier sphere under colonial strategic pressure. C. The Second Anglo-Burmese War of 1852 led to the annexation of Lower Burma under Dalhousie. D. The Third Anglo-Burmese War of 1885 led to the annexation of Upper Burma under Dufferin.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Durand agreement of 1893 marked the Afghan frontier sphere under colonial strategic pressure. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q31. Which option should a candidate retain when revising Durand Line?

A. Burma remained administratively part of British India until its separation in 1937. B. The Third Anglo-Burmese War of 1885 led to the annexation of Upper Burma under Dufferin. C. The Durand agreement of 1893 marked the Afghan frontier sphere under colonial strategic pressure. D. The Second Anglo-Burmese War of 1852 led to the annexation of Lower Burma under Dalhousie.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Durand agreement of 1893 marked the Afghan frontier sphere under colonial strategic pressure. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q32. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about Durand Line?

A. The Anglo-Nepalese War of 1814-16 ended with the Treaty of Sagauli. B. Burma remained administratively part of British India until its separation in 1937. C. The Third Anglo-Burmese War of 1885 led to the annexation of Upper Burma under Dufferin. D. The Durand agreement of 1893 marked the Afghan frontier sphere under colonial strategic pressure.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Durand agreement of 1893 marked the Afghan frontier sphere under colonial strategic pressure. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q33. Which statement correctly identifies North-West Frontier Province?

A. Curzon created the North-West Frontier Province in 1901 as a special frontier administration. B. The Second Anglo-Burmese War of 1852 led to the annexation of Lower Burma under Dalhousie. C. The Third Anglo-Burmese War of 1885 led to the annexation of Upper Burma under Dufferin. D. The First Anglo-Burmese War of 1824-26 ended with the Treaty of Yandabo.

Answer: A. Explanation: Curzon created the North-West Frontier Province in 1901 as a special frontier administration. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q34. Which chronology card should be filed under North-West Frontier Province?

A. Burma remained administratively part of British India until its separation in 1937. B. Curzon created the North-West Frontier Province in 1901 as a special frontier administration. C. The Third Anglo-Burmese War of 1885 led to the annexation of Upper Burma under Dufferin. D. The Second Anglo-Burmese War of 1852 led to the annexation of Lower Burma under Dalhousie.

Answer: B. Explanation: Curzon created the North-West Frontier Province in 1901 as a special frontier administration. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q35. Which option should a candidate retain when revising North-West Frontier Province?

A. The Anglo-Nepalese War of 1814-16 ended with the Treaty of Sagauli. B. The Third Anglo-Burmese War of 1885 led to the annexation of Upper Burma under Dufferin. C. Curzon created the North-West Frontier Province in 1901 as a special frontier administration. D. Burma remained administratively part of British India until its separation in 1937.

Answer: C. Explanation: Curzon created the North-West Frontier Province in 1901 as a special frontier administration. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q36. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about North-West Frontier Province?

A. The Nepal settlement combined a British Residency, buffer-state influence and Gurkha recruitment without annexation. B. Burma remained administratively part of British India until its separation in 1937. C. The Anglo-Nepalese War of 1814-16 ended with the Treaty of Sagauli. D. Curzon created the North-West Frontier Province in 1901 as a special frontier administration.

Answer: D. Explanation: Curzon created the North-West Frontier Province in 1901 as a special frontier administration. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q37. Which statement correctly identifies First Anglo-Burmese War?

A. The First Anglo-Burmese War of 1824-26 ended with the Treaty of Yandabo. B. The Third Anglo-Burmese War of 1885 led to the annexation of Upper Burma under Dufferin. C. The Second Anglo-Burmese War of 1852 led to the annexation of Lower Burma under Dalhousie. D. Burma remained administratively part of British India until its separation in 1937.

Answer: A. Explanation: The First Anglo-Burmese War of 1824-26 ended with the Treaty of Yandabo. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q38. Which chronology card should be filed under First Anglo-Burmese War?

A. Burma remained administratively part of British India until its separation in 1937. B. The First Anglo-Burmese War of 1824-26 ended with the Treaty of Yandabo. C. The Anglo-Nepalese War of 1814-16 ended with the Treaty of Sagauli. D. The Third Anglo-Burmese War of 1885 led to the annexation of Upper Burma under Dufferin.

Answer: B. Explanation: The First Anglo-Burmese War of 1824-26 ended with the Treaty of Yandabo. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q39. Which option should a candidate retain when revising First Anglo-Burmese War?

A. Burma remained administratively part of British India until its separation in 1937. B. The Nepal settlement combined a British Residency, buffer-state influence and Gurkha recruitment without annexation. C. The First Anglo-Burmese War of 1824-26 ended with the Treaty of Yandabo. D. The Anglo-Nepalese War of 1814-16 ended with the Treaty of Sagauli.

Answer: C. Explanation: The First Anglo-Burmese War of 1824-26 ended with the Treaty of Yandabo. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q40. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about First Anglo-Burmese War?

A. The Nepal settlement combined a British Residency, buffer-state influence and Gurkha recruitment without annexation. B. The Anglo-Nepalese War of 1814-16 ended with the Treaty of Sagauli. C. Curzon's Younghusband Mission entered Tibet in 1904 and produced the Lhasa Convention. D. The First Anglo-Burmese War of 1824-26 ended with the Treaty of Yandabo.

Answer: D. Explanation: The First Anglo-Burmese War of 1824-26 ended with the Treaty of Yandabo. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q41. Which statement correctly identifies Second Anglo-Burmese War?

A. The Second Anglo-Burmese War of 1852 led to the annexation of Lower Burma under Dalhousie. B. Burma remained administratively part of British India until its separation in 1937. C. The Third Anglo-Burmese War of 1885 led to the annexation of Upper Burma under Dufferin. D. The Anglo-Nepalese War of 1814-16 ended with the Treaty of Sagauli.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Second Anglo-Burmese War of 1852 led to the annexation of Lower Burma under Dalhousie. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q42. Which chronology card should be filed under Second Anglo-Burmese War?

A. The Anglo-Nepalese War of 1814-16 ended with the Treaty of Sagauli. B. The Second Anglo-Burmese War of 1852 led to the annexation of Lower Burma under Dalhousie. C. The Nepal settlement combined a British Residency, buffer-state influence and Gurkha recruitment without annexation. D. Burma remained administratively part of British India until its separation in 1937.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Second Anglo-Burmese War of 1852 led to the annexation of Lower Burma under Dalhousie. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q43. Which option should a candidate retain when revising Second Anglo-Burmese War?

A. The Nepal settlement combined a British Residency, buffer-state influence and Gurkha recruitment without annexation. B. Curzon's Younghusband Mission entered Tibet in 1904 and produced the Lhasa Convention. C. The Second Anglo-Burmese War of 1852 led to the annexation of Lower Burma under Dalhousie. D. The Anglo-Nepalese War of 1814-16 ended with the Treaty of Sagauli.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Second Anglo-Burmese War of 1852 led to the annexation of Lower Burma under Dalhousie. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q44. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about Second Anglo-Burmese War?

A. The Nepal settlement combined a British Residency, buffer-state influence and Gurkha recruitment without annexation. B. Curzon's Younghusband Mission entered Tibet in 1904 and produced the Lhasa Convention. C. Treaties and protectorate-style influence drew Sikkim and Bhutan into the Himalayan buffer system. D. The Second Anglo-Burmese War of 1852 led to the annexation of Lower Burma under Dalhousie.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Second Anglo-Burmese War of 1852 led to the annexation of Lower Burma under Dalhousie. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q45. Which statement correctly identifies Third Anglo-Burmese War?

A. The Third Anglo-Burmese War of 1885 led to the annexation of Upper Burma under Dufferin. B. The Anglo-Nepalese War of 1814-16 ended with the Treaty of Sagauli. C. Burma remained administratively part of British India until its separation in 1937. D. The Nepal settlement combined a British Residency, buffer-state influence and Gurkha recruitment without annexation.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Third Anglo-Burmese War of 1885 led to the annexation of Upper Burma under Dufferin. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q46. Which chronology card should be filed under Third Anglo-Burmese War?

A. Curzon's Younghusband Mission entered Tibet in 1904 and produced the Lhasa Convention. B. The Third Anglo-Burmese War of 1885 led to the annexation of Upper Burma under Dufferin. C. The Nepal settlement combined a British Residency, buffer-state influence and Gurkha recruitment without annexation. D. The Anglo-Nepalese War of 1814-16 ended with the Treaty of Sagauli.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Third Anglo-Burmese War of 1885 led to the annexation of Upper Burma under Dufferin. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q47. Which option should a candidate retain when revising Third Anglo-Burmese War?

A. Curzon's Younghusband Mission entered Tibet in 1904 and produced the Lhasa Convention. B. Treaties and protectorate-style influence drew Sikkim and Bhutan into the Himalayan buffer system. C. The Third Anglo-Burmese War of 1885 led to the annexation of Upper Burma under Dufferin. D. The Nepal settlement combined a British Residency, buffer-state influence and Gurkha recruitment without annexation.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Third Anglo-Burmese War of 1885 led to the annexation of Upper Burma under Dufferin. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q48. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about Third Anglo-Burmese War?

A. Afghanistan and Nepal were managed mainly as buffers, whereas Burma was conquered and annexed in stages. B. Curzon's Younghusband Mission entered Tibet in 1904 and produced the Lhasa Convention. C. Treaties and protectorate-style influence drew Sikkim and Bhutan into the Himalayan buffer system. D. The Third Anglo-Burmese War of 1885 led to the annexation of Upper Burma under Dufferin.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Third Anglo-Burmese War of 1885 led to the annexation of Upper Burma under Dufferin. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q49. Which statement correctly identifies Burma and British India?

A. Burma remained administratively part of British India until its separation in 1937. B. The Nepal settlement combined a British Residency, buffer-state influence and Gurkha recruitment without annexation. C. Curzon's Younghusband Mission entered Tibet in 1904 and produced the Lhasa Convention. D. The Anglo-Nepalese War of 1814-16 ended with the Treaty of Sagauli.

Answer: A. Explanation: Burma remained administratively part of British India until its separation in 1937. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q50. Which chronology card should be filed under Burma and British India?

A. Curzon's Younghusband Mission entered Tibet in 1904 and produced the Lhasa Convention. B. Burma remained administratively part of British India until its separation in 1937. C. The Nepal settlement combined a British Residency, buffer-state influence and Gurkha recruitment without annexation. D. Treaties and protectorate-style influence drew Sikkim and Bhutan into the Himalayan buffer system.

Answer: B. Explanation: Burma remained administratively part of British India until its separation in 1937. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q51. Which option should a candidate retain when revising Burma and British India?

A. Curzon's Younghusband Mission entered Tibet in 1904 and produced the Lhasa Convention. B. Afghanistan and Nepal were managed mainly as buffers, whereas Burma was conquered and annexed in stages. C. Burma remained administratively part of British India until its separation in 1937. D. Treaties and protectorate-style influence drew Sikkim and Bhutan into the Himalayan buffer system.

Answer: C. Explanation: Burma remained administratively part of British India until its separation in 1937. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q52. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about Burma and British India?

A. Treaties and protectorate-style influence drew Sikkim and Bhutan into the Himalayan buffer system. B. Afghanistan and Nepal were managed mainly as buffers, whereas Burma was conquered and annexed in stages. C. Frontier wars and garrisons were charged to Indian revenue even when their strategic purpose was imperial. D. Burma remained administratively part of British India until its separation in 1937.

Answer: D. Explanation: Burma remained administratively part of British India until its separation in 1937. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q53. Which statement correctly identifies Anglo-Nepalese War?

A. The Anglo-Nepalese War of 1814-16 ended with the Treaty of Sagauli. B. Treaties and protectorate-style influence drew Sikkim and Bhutan into the Himalayan buffer system. C. Curzon's Younghusband Mission entered Tibet in 1904 and produced the Lhasa Convention. D. The Nepal settlement combined a British Residency, buffer-state influence and Gurkha recruitment without annexation.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Anglo-Nepalese War of 1814-16 ended with the Treaty of Sagauli. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q54. Which chronology card should be filed under Anglo-Nepalese War?

A. Afghanistan and Nepal were managed mainly as buffers, whereas Burma was conquered and annexed in stages. B. The Anglo-Nepalese War of 1814-16 ended with the Treaty of Sagauli. C. Treaties and protectorate-style influence drew Sikkim and Bhutan into the Himalayan buffer system. D. Curzon's Younghusband Mission entered Tibet in 1904 and produced the Lhasa Convention.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Anglo-Nepalese War of 1814-16 ended with the Treaty of Sagauli. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q55. Which option should a candidate retain when revising Anglo-Nepalese War?

A. Treaties and protectorate-style influence drew Sikkim and Bhutan into the Himalayan buffer system. B. Frontier wars and garrisons were charged to Indian revenue even when their strategic purpose was imperial. C. The Anglo-Nepalese War of 1814-16 ended with the Treaty of Sagauli. D. Afghanistan and Nepal were managed mainly as buffers, whereas Burma was conquered and annexed in stages.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Anglo-Nepalese War of 1814-16 ended with the Treaty of Sagauli. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q56. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about Anglo-Nepalese War?

A. Frontier wars and garrisons were charged to Indian revenue even when their strategic purpose was imperial. B. Independent India inherited frontier lines and administrative habits designed for empire rather than national democratic consent. C. Afghanistan and Nepal were managed mainly as buffers, whereas Burma was conquered and annexed in stages. D. The Anglo-Nepalese War of 1814-16 ended with the Treaty of Sagauli.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Anglo-Nepalese War of 1814-16 ended with the Treaty of Sagauli. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q57. Which statement correctly identifies Nepal settlement?

A. The Nepal settlement combined a British Residency, buffer-state influence and Gurkha recruitment without annexation. B. Treaties and protectorate-style influence drew Sikkim and Bhutan into the Himalayan buffer system. C. Curzon's Younghusband Mission entered Tibet in 1904 and produced the Lhasa Convention. D. Afghanistan and Nepal were managed mainly as buffers, whereas Burma was conquered and annexed in stages.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Nepal settlement combined a British Residency, buffer-state influence and Gurkha recruitment without annexation. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q58. Which chronology card should be filed under Nepal settlement?

A. Frontier wars and garrisons were charged to Indian revenue even when their strategic purpose was imperial. B. The Nepal settlement combined a British Residency, buffer-state influence and Gurkha recruitment without annexation. C. Treaties and protectorate-style influence drew Sikkim and Bhutan into the Himalayan buffer system. D. Afghanistan and Nepal were managed mainly as buffers, whereas Burma was conquered and annexed in stages.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Nepal settlement combined a British Residency, buffer-state influence and Gurkha recruitment without annexation. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q59. Which option should a candidate retain when revising Nepal settlement?

A. Afghanistan and Nepal were managed mainly as buffers, whereas Burma was conquered and annexed in stages. B. Frontier wars and garrisons were charged to Indian revenue even when their strategic purpose was imperial. C. The Nepal settlement combined a British Residency, buffer-state influence and Gurkha recruitment without annexation. D. Independent India inherited frontier lines and administrative habits designed for empire rather than national democratic consent.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Nepal settlement combined a British Residency, buffer-state influence and Gurkha recruitment without annexation. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q60. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about Nepal settlement?

A. Independent India inherited frontier lines and administrative habits designed for empire rather than national democratic consent. B. British India treated neighbouring states and frontier zones as a strategic ring around the Indian empire. C. Frontier wars and garrisons were charged to Indian revenue even when their strategic purpose was imperial. D. The Nepal settlement combined a British Residency, buffer-state influence and Gurkha recruitment without annexation.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Nepal settlement combined a British Residency, buffer-state influence and Gurkha recruitment without annexation. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q61. Which statement correctly identifies Younghusband Mission?

A. Curzon's Younghusband Mission entered Tibet in 1904 and produced the Lhasa Convention. B. Afghanistan and Nepal were managed mainly as buffers, whereas Burma was conquered and annexed in stages. C. Frontier wars and garrisons were charged to Indian revenue even when their strategic purpose was imperial. D. Treaties and protectorate-style influence drew Sikkim and Bhutan into the Himalayan buffer system.

Answer: A. Explanation: Curzon's Younghusband Mission entered Tibet in 1904 and produced the Lhasa Convention. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q62. Which chronology card should be filed under Younghusband Mission?

A. Afghanistan and Nepal were managed mainly as buffers, whereas Burma was conquered and annexed in stages. B. Curzon's Younghusband Mission entered Tibet in 1904 and produced the Lhasa Convention. C. Frontier wars and garrisons were charged to Indian revenue even when their strategic purpose was imperial. D. Independent India inherited frontier lines and administrative habits designed for empire rather than national democratic consent.

Answer: B. Explanation: Curzon's Younghusband Mission entered Tibet in 1904 and produced the Lhasa Convention. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q63. Which option should a candidate retain when revising Younghusband Mission?

A. British India treated neighbouring states and frontier zones as a strategic ring around the Indian empire. B. Independent India inherited frontier lines and administrative habits designed for empire rather than national democratic consent. C. Curzon's Younghusband Mission entered Tibet in 1904 and produced the Lhasa Convention. D. Frontier wars and garrisons were charged to Indian revenue even when their strategic purpose was imperial.

Answer: C. Explanation: Curzon's Younghusband Mission entered Tibet in 1904 and produced the Lhasa Convention. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q64. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about Younghusband Mission?

A. British India treated neighbouring states and frontier zones as a strategic ring around the Indian empire. B. Independent India inherited frontier lines and administrative habits designed for empire rather than national democratic consent. C. The Great Game describes Anglo-Russian rivalry in Central Asia that shaped British policy toward Afghanistan. D. Curzon's Younghusband Mission entered Tibet in 1904 and produced the Lhasa Convention.

Answer: D. Explanation: Curzon's Younghusband Mission entered Tibet in 1904 and produced the Lhasa Convention. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q65. Which statement correctly identifies Sikkim and Bhutan?

A. Treaties and protectorate-style influence drew Sikkim and Bhutan into the Himalayan buffer system. B. Independent India inherited frontier lines and administrative habits designed for empire rather than national democratic consent. C. Frontier wars and garrisons were charged to Indian revenue even when their strategic purpose was imperial. D. Afghanistan and Nepal were managed mainly as buffers, whereas Burma was conquered and annexed in stages.

Answer: A. Explanation: Treaties and protectorate-style influence drew Sikkim and Bhutan into the Himalayan buffer system. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q66. Which chronology card should be filed under Sikkim and Bhutan?

A. Independent India inherited frontier lines and administrative habits designed for empire rather than national democratic consent. B. Treaties and protectorate-style influence drew Sikkim and Bhutan into the Himalayan buffer system. C. British India treated neighbouring states and frontier zones as a strategic ring around the Indian empire. D. Frontier wars and garrisons were charged to Indian revenue even when their strategic purpose was imperial.

Answer: B. Explanation: Treaties and protectorate-style influence drew Sikkim and Bhutan into the Himalayan buffer system. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q67. Which option should a candidate retain when revising Sikkim and Bhutan?

A. The Great Game describes Anglo-Russian rivalry in Central Asia that shaped British policy toward Afghanistan. B. Independent India inherited frontier lines and administrative habits designed for empire rather than national democratic consent. C. Treaties and protectorate-style influence drew Sikkim and Bhutan into the Himalayan buffer system. D. British India treated neighbouring states and frontier zones as a strategic ring around the Indian empire.

Answer: C. Explanation: Treaties and protectorate-style influence drew Sikkim and Bhutan into the Himalayan buffer system. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q68. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about Sikkim and Bhutan?

A. The Great Game describes Anglo-Russian rivalry in Central Asia that shaped British policy toward Afghanistan. B. Close-border policy sought to defend settled limits without permanent advance into tribal or Afghan territory. C. British India treated neighbouring states and frontier zones as a strategic ring around the Indian empire. D. Treaties and protectorate-style influence drew Sikkim and Bhutan into the Himalayan buffer system.

Answer: D. Explanation: Treaties and protectorate-style influence drew Sikkim and Bhutan into the Himalayan buffer system. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q69. Which statement correctly identifies Buffer versus annexation?

A. Afghanistan and Nepal were managed mainly as buffers, whereas Burma was conquered and annexed in stages. B. British India treated neighbouring states and frontier zones as a strategic ring around the Indian empire. C. Independent India inherited frontier lines and administrative habits designed for empire rather than national democratic consent. D. Frontier wars and garrisons were charged to Indian revenue even when their strategic purpose was imperial.

Answer: A. Explanation: Afghanistan and Nepal were managed mainly as buffers, whereas Burma was conquered and annexed in stages. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q70. Which chronology card should be filed under Buffer versus annexation?

A. British India treated neighbouring states and frontier zones as a strategic ring around the Indian empire. B. Afghanistan and Nepal were managed mainly as buffers, whereas Burma was conquered and annexed in stages. C. The Great Game describes Anglo-Russian rivalry in Central Asia that shaped British policy toward Afghanistan. D. Independent India inherited frontier lines and administrative habits designed for empire rather than national democratic consent.

Answer: B. Explanation: Afghanistan and Nepal were managed mainly as buffers, whereas Burma was conquered and annexed in stages. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q71. Which option should a candidate retain when revising Buffer versus annexation?

A. The Great Game describes Anglo-Russian rivalry in Central Asia that shaped British policy toward Afghanistan. B. British India treated neighbouring states and frontier zones as a strategic ring around the Indian empire. C. Afghanistan and Nepal were managed mainly as buffers, whereas Burma was conquered and annexed in stages. D. Close-border policy sought to defend settled limits without permanent advance into tribal or Afghan territory.

Answer: C. Explanation: Afghanistan and Nepal were managed mainly as buffers, whereas Burma was conquered and annexed in stages. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q72. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about Buffer versus annexation?

A. Close-border policy sought to defend settled limits without permanent advance into tribal or Afghan territory. B. Forward policy used missions, posts, subsidies, war and political control to pre-empt perceived rival influence. C. The Great Game describes Anglo-Russian rivalry in Central Asia that shaped British policy toward Afghanistan. D. Afghanistan and Nepal were managed mainly as buffers, whereas Burma was conquered and annexed in stages.

Answer: D. Explanation: Afghanistan and Nepal were managed mainly as buffers, whereas Burma was conquered and annexed in stages. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q73. Which statement correctly identifies Indian revenue burden?

A. Frontier wars and garrisons were charged to Indian revenue even when their strategic purpose was imperial. B. The Great Game describes Anglo-Russian rivalry in Central Asia that shaped British policy toward Afghanistan. C. British India treated neighbouring states and frontier zones as a strategic ring around the Indian empire. D. Independent India inherited frontier lines and administrative habits designed for empire rather than national democratic consent.

Answer: A. Explanation: Frontier wars and garrisons were charged to Indian revenue even when their strategic purpose was imperial. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q74. Which chronology card should be filed under Indian revenue burden?

A. The Great Game describes Anglo-Russian rivalry in Central Asia that shaped British policy toward Afghanistan. B. Frontier wars and garrisons were charged to Indian revenue even when their strategic purpose was imperial. C. Close-border policy sought to defend settled limits without permanent advance into tribal or Afghan territory. D. British India treated neighbouring states and frontier zones as a strategic ring around the Indian empire.

Answer: B. Explanation: Frontier wars and garrisons were charged to Indian revenue even when their strategic purpose was imperial. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q75. Which option should a candidate retain when revising Indian revenue burden?

A. Close-border policy sought to defend settled limits without permanent advance into tribal or Afghan territory. B. Forward policy used missions, posts, subsidies, war and political control to pre-empt perceived rival influence. C. Frontier wars and garrisons were charged to Indian revenue even when their strategic purpose was imperial. D. The Great Game describes Anglo-Russian rivalry in Central Asia that shaped British policy toward Afghanistan.

Answer: C. Explanation: Frontier wars and garrisons were charged to Indian revenue even when their strategic purpose was imperial. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q76. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about Indian revenue burden?

A. Forward policy used missions, posts, subsidies, war and political control to pre-empt perceived rival influence. B. The First Anglo-Afghan War of 1839-42 ended in a disastrous British retreat from Kabul. C. Close-border policy sought to defend settled limits without permanent advance into tribal or Afghan territory. D. Frontier wars and garrisons were charged to Indian revenue even when their strategic purpose was imperial.

Answer: D. Explanation: Frontier wars and garrisons were charged to Indian revenue even when their strategic purpose was imperial. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Boundary legacy?

A. Independent India inherited frontier lines and administrative habits designed for empire rather than national democratic consent. B. Close-border policy sought to defend settled limits without permanent advance into tribal or Afghan territory. C. British India treated neighbouring states and frontier zones as a strategic ring around the Indian empire. D. The Great Game describes Anglo-Russian rivalry in Central Asia that shaped British policy toward Afghanistan.

Answer: A. Explanation: Independent India inherited frontier lines and administrative habits designed for empire rather than national democratic consent. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q78. Which chronology card should be filed under Boundary legacy?

A. The Great Game describes Anglo-Russian rivalry in Central Asia that shaped British policy toward Afghanistan. B. Independent India inherited frontier lines and administrative habits designed for empire rather than national democratic consent. C. Forward policy used missions, posts, subsidies, war and political control to pre-empt perceived rival influence. D. Close-border policy sought to defend settled limits without permanent advance into tribal or Afghan territory.

Answer: B. Explanation: Independent India inherited frontier lines and administrative habits designed for empire rather than national democratic consent. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q79. Which option should a candidate retain when revising Boundary legacy?

A. Forward policy used missions, posts, subsidies, war and political control to pre-empt perceived rival influence. B. Close-border policy sought to defend settled limits without permanent advance into tribal or Afghan territory. C. Independent India inherited frontier lines and administrative habits designed for empire rather than national democratic consent. D. The First Anglo-Afghan War of 1839-42 ended in a disastrous British retreat from Kabul.

Answer: C. Explanation: Independent India inherited frontier lines and administrative habits designed for empire rather than national democratic consent. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q80. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about Boundary legacy?

A. The First Anglo-Afghan War of 1839-42 ended in a disastrous British retreat from Kabul. B. Forward policy used missions, posts, subsidies, war and political control to pre-empt perceived rival influence. C. The Second Anglo-Afghan War of 1878-80 reflected Lytton's forward policy. D. Independent India inherited frontier lines and administrative habits designed for empire rather than national democratic consent.

Answer: D. Explanation: Independent India inherited frontier lines and administrative habits designed for empire rather than national democratic consent. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

TRANSPARENT ZERO-DIRECT-PYQ AUDIT

Repository routing audits assign no direct Modern-History PYQ to Topic 13. Geography and International Relations questions on current neighbours remain outside this owner's historical frontier-policy scope.

No adjacent Geography, International Relations, Governance or Polity question is relabelled as a direct Modern History PYQ.

ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

Question: Why did British frontier policy oscillate between close-border and forward approaches? Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Neither low-cost restraint nor expensive advance fully resolved rivalry, tribal autonomy and the problem of buffer control.

Evidence spine:

- The Great Game describes Anglo-Russian rivalry in Central Asia that shaped British policy toward Afghanistan.
- Close-border policy sought to defend settled limits without permanent advance into tribal or Afghan territory.
- Forward policy used missions, posts, subsidies, war and political control to pre-empt perceived rival influence.
- Curzon created the North-West Frontier Province in 1901 as a special frontier administration.

Balance: Distinguish intention from outcome, identify regional or social variation, and avoid treating a formal measure as complete implementation.

Conclusion: Neither low-cost restraint nor expensive advance fully resolved rivalry, tribal autonomy and the problem of buffer control.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “Why did British frontier policy oscillate between close-border and forward approaches?...”, coverage of every clause, chronological-causal analysis, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified verdict.

Detailed examiner-grade model status: The solved analysis above is the executable content base. Preserve its exact chronology, named evidence, causal logic, counter-position and qualification.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 10-mark answer, open with a two-sentence thesis; organise three named Acts, events, organisations, regions, primary records or scholarly positions as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded conclusion.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, distinguishes dates and policy stages, connects evidence to mechanism, recognises regional/social variation and avoids teleology or hero worship.

How to improve this answer: For “Why did British frontier policy oscillate between close-border and forward approaches?...”, replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named primary/official record or attributed scholarly interpretation and state exactly what it cannot prove.

ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

Question: Distinguish the Treaty of Yandabo, Treaty of Sagauli and Treaty of Gandamak. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: The three treaties belong to different theatres, wars and strategic outcomes and should be learned as a comparison set.

Evidence spine:

- The Treaty of Gandamak of 1879 followed the Second Anglo-Afghan War and expanded British influence over Afghan external affairs.
- The First Anglo-Burmese War of 1824-26 ended with the Treaty of Yandabo.
- The Anglo-Nepalese War of 1814-16 ended with the Treaty of Sagauli.

Balance: Distinguish intention from outcome, identify regional or social variation, and avoid treating a formal measure as complete implementation.

Conclusion: The three treaties belong to different theatres, wars and strategic outcomes and should be learned as a comparison set.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “Distinguish the Treaty of Yandabo, Treaty of Sagauli and Treaty of Gandamak. Answer in...”, coverage of every clause, chronological-causal analysis, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified verdict.

Detailed examiner-grade model status: The solved analysis above is the executable content base. Preserve its exact chronology, named evidence, causal logic, counter-position and qualification.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 10-mark answer, open with a two-sentence thesis; organise three named Acts, events, organisations, regions, primary records or scholarly positions as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded conclusion.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, distinguishes dates and policy stages, connects evidence to mechanism, recognises regional/social variation and avoids teleology or hero worship.

How to improve this answer: For “Distinguish the Treaty of Yandabo, Treaty of Sagauli and Treaty of Gandamak. Answer in...”, replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named primary/official record or attributed scholarly interpretation and state exactly what it cannot prove.

ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS

Question: Compare British policy toward Afghanistan and Burma. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Afghanistan was preserved as a controlled buffer against a great-power threat, while Burma was annexed where commercial and strategic expansion faced no equivalent rival.

Evidence spine:

- The Great Game describes Anglo-Russian rivalry in Central Asia that shaped British policy toward Afghanistan.
- The First Anglo-Afghan War of 1839-42 ended in a disastrous British retreat from Kabul.
- The Second Anglo-Afghan War of 1878-80 reflected Lytton's forward policy.
- The Treaty of Gandamak of 1879 followed the Second Anglo-Afghan War and expanded British influence over Afghan external affairs.
- The First Anglo-Burmese War of 1824-26 ended with the Treaty of Yandabo.
- The Second Anglo-Burmese War of 1852 led to the annexation of Lower Burma under Dalhousie.
- The Third Anglo-Burmese War of 1885 led to the annexation of Upper Burma under Dufferin.
- Afghanistan and Nepal were managed mainly as buffers, whereas Burma was conquered and annexed in stages.

Balance: Distinguish intention from outcome, identify regional or social variation, and avoid treating a formal measure as complete implementation.

Conclusion: Afghanistan was preserved as a controlled buffer against a great-power threat, while Burma was annexed where commercial and strategic expansion faced no equivalent rival.

Demand decoding: The directive **compare** requires a direct position on “Compare British policy toward Afghanistan and Burma. Answer in about 250 words.”, coverage of every clause, chronological-causal analysis, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified verdict.

Detailed examiner-grade model status: The solved analysis above is the executable content base. Preserve its exact chronology, named evidence, causal logic, counter-position and qualification.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, open with a two-sentence thesis; organise five named Acts, events, organisations, regions, primary records or scholarly positions as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded conclusion.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, distinguishes dates and policy stages, connects evidence to mechanism, recognises regional/social variation and avoids teleology or hero worship.

How to improve this answer: For “Compare British policy toward Afghanistan and Burma. Answer in about 250 words.”, replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named primary/official record or attributed scholarly interpretation and state exactly what it cannot prove.

ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

Question: Assess Nepal's place in the British Indian frontier system. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Nepal combined defeat, treaty dependence, diplomatic influence and military recruitment without loss of formal statehood.

Evidence spine:

- The Anglo-Nepalese War of 1814-16 ended with the Treaty of Sagauli.
- The Nepal settlement combined a British Residency, buffer-state influence and Gurkha recruitment without annexation.
- Afghanistan and Nepal were managed mainly as buffers, whereas Burma was conquered and annexed in stages.

Balance: Distinguish intention from outcome, identify regional or social variation, and avoid treating a formal measure as complete implementation.

Conclusion: Nepal combined defeat, treaty dependence, diplomatic influence and military recruitment without loss of formal statehood.

Demand decoding: The directive **assess** requires a direct position on "Assess Nepal's place in the British Indian frontier system. Answer in about 250 words.", coverage of every clause, chronological-causal analysis, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified verdict.

Detailed examiner-grade model status: The solved analysis above is the executable content base. Preserve its exact chronology, named evidence, causal logic, counter-position and qualification.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, open with a two-sentence thesis; organise five named Acts, events, organisations, regions, primary records or scholarly positions as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded conclusion.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, distinguishes dates and policy stages, connects evidence to mechanism, recognises regional/social variation and avoids teleology or hero worship.

How to improve this answer: For "Assess Nepal's place in the British Indian frontier system. Answer in about 250 words.", replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named primary/official record or attributed scholarly interpretation and state exactly what it cannot prove.

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS

Question: Analyse the strategic, commercial and fiscal dimensions of British frontier policy. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: Security language joined rival-power fear, commercial expansion and costs imposed on Indian revenue across distinct frontier theatres.

Evidence spine:

- British India treated neighbouring states and frontier zones as a strategic ring around the Indian empire.
- The Great Game describes Anglo-Russian rivalry in Central Asia that shaped British policy toward Afghanistan.
- Forward policy used missions, posts, subsidies, war and political control to pre-empt perceived rival influence.
- The First Anglo-Burmese War of 1824-26 ended with the Treaty of Yandabo.
- The Second Anglo-Burmese War of 1852 led to the annexation of Lower Burma under Dalhousie.
- The Third Anglo-Burmese War of 1885 led to the annexation of Upper Burma under Dufferin.
- Curzon's Younghusband Mission entered Tibet in 1904 and produced the Lhasa Convention.
- Frontier wars and garrisons were charged to Indian revenue even when their strategic purpose was imperial.

Balance: Distinguish intention from outcome, identify regional or social variation, and avoid treating a formal measure as complete implementation.

Conclusion: Security language joined rival-power fear, commercial expansion and costs imposed on Indian revenue across distinct frontier theatres.

Demand decoding: The directive **analyse** requires a direct position on “Analyse the strategic, commercial and fiscal dimensions of British frontier policy. Answer...”, coverage of every clause, chronological-causal analysis, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified verdict.

Detailed examiner-grade model status: The solved analysis above is the executable content base. Preserve its exact chronology, named evidence, causal logic, counter-position and qualification.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 20-mark answer, open with a two-sentence thesis; organise six to eight named Acts, events, organisations, regions, primary records or scholarly positions as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded conclusion.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, distinguishes dates and policy stages, connects evidence to mechanism, recognises regional/social variation and avoids teleology or hero worship.

How to improve this answer: For “Analyse the strategic, commercial and fiscal dimensions of British frontier policy. Answer...”, replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named primary/official record or attributed scholarly interpretation and state exactly what it cannot prove.

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

Question: Evaluate the post-colonial legacy of colonial frontier-making in South Asia. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: The empire left boundaries and exceptional frontier institutions shaped by imperial security, requiring independent states to manage inherited mismatches.

Evidence spine:

- The Durand agreement of 1893 marked the Afghan frontier sphere under colonial strategic pressure.
- Curzon created the North-West Frontier Province in 1901 as a special frontier administration.
- Burma remained administratively part of British India until its separation in 1937.
- Curzon's Younghusband Mission entered Tibet in 1904 and produced the Lhasa Convention.
- Treaties and protectorate-style influence drew Sikkim and Bhutan into the Himalayan buffer system.
- Independent India inherited frontier lines and administrative habits designed for empire rather than national democratic consent.

Balance: Distinguish intention from outcome, identify regional or social variation, and avoid treating a formal measure as complete implementation.

Conclusion: The empire left boundaries and exceptional frontier institutions shaped by imperial security, requiring independent states to manage inherited mismatches.

Demand decoding: The directive **evaluate** requires a direct position on “Evaluate the post-colonial legacy of colonial frontier-making in South Asia. Answer in...”, coverage of every clause, chronological-causal analysis, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified verdict.

Detailed examiner-grade model status: The solved analysis above is the executable content base. Preserve its exact chronology, named evidence, causal logic, counter-position and qualification.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 20-mark answer, open with a two-sentence thesis; organise six to eight named Acts, events, organisations, regions, primary records or scholarly positions as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded conclusion.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, distinguishes dates and policy stages, connects evidence to mechanism, recognises regional/social variation and avoids teleology or hero worship.

How to improve this answer: For “Evaluate the post-colonial legacy of colonial frontier-making in South Asia. Answer in...”, replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named primary/official record or attributed scholarly interpretation and state exactly what it cannot prove.

OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH - NOT REQUIRED FOR A CORE ANSWER

Mini-timeline

Date	Event
FACT: 1814-16	Anglo-Nepalese War ended with Treaty of Sagauli
FACT: 1824-26	First Anglo-Burmese War ended with Treaty of Yandabo
FACT: 1839-42	First Anglo-Afghan War ended in disastrous retreat from Kabul
FACT: 1878-80	Second Anglo-Afghan War under Lytton; Treaty of Gandamak
FACT: 1885	Third Anglo-Burmese War annexed Upper Burma under Dufferin
FACT: 1893	Durand Line agreement marked the Afghan frontier sphere
FACT: 1901	Curzon created the North-West Frontier Province
FACT: 1904	Younghusband Mission entered Tibet; Lhasa Convention followed

1. Snapshot & core idea

Deeper - frontier policy was the external face of the Indian empire.

- FACT: British India treated Afghanistan, Burma, Nepal, Tibet, Sikkim and Bhutan not as distant foreign-policy questions but as security extensions of the Indian empire.
- FACT: The north-west frontier was dominated by fear of Russia, known as the **Great Game**, and by the debate between close-border and forward policies.
- FACT: The First Anglo-Afghan War (1839-42) showed the danger of aggressive intervention; the Second Anglo-Afghan War (1878-80) produced the Treaty of Gandamak and reinforced British control over Afghan external relations.
- ANALYSIS: The frontier was both a military zone and an ideological zone where imperial rulers claimed to defend India by controlling neighbours.

Deeper - eastern and Himalayan frontiers mixed trade, security and annexation.

- FACT: Burma was conquered in stages through three wars; after the Third Anglo-Burmese War (1885), Upper Burma was annexed and Burma remained tied administratively to India until 1937.
- FACT: Nepal was not annexed after the Treaty of Sagauli; it became a buffer with a Residency and a source of Gurkha recruitment.
- FACT: Tibet drew Curzon's attention because of fears about Russian influence; the Younghusband Mission of 1904 reflected forward frontier activism.
- ANALYSIS: These policies left boundary legacies, strategic habits and frontier zones that continued to matter after independence.

2. Key classification / data

Frontier model	Region	Advanced significance
FACT: Buffer-state model	Afghanistan, Nepal, Bhutan, Sikkim	Security through controlled autonomy and treaty influence
FACT: Forward policy	Afghanistan, NW Frontier, Tibet under Curzon	Active advance to pre-empt rival influence
FACT: Close-border policy	North-West Frontier debate	Avoid costly occupation beyond settled borders
FACT: Annexation model	Burma	Strategic and commercial expansion eastward
FACT: Treaty frontier	Sagauli, Yandabo, Gandamak, Durand Line	Treaties translated war into boundary and influence systems
ANALYSIS: Paramountcy logic	Princely states and border polities	Indirect control without formal annexation
ANALYSIS: Post-1947 legacy	Durand Line, Myanmar border, Himalayan frontier	Colonial boundaries outlived the empire

3. Study links

Study link: FACT: Expansionist instruments under Wellesley and Dalhousie -> advanced/05_British-Territorial-Expansion.md. **Study link:** FACT: Crown-era imperial bureaucracy and Curzon's administrative style -> advanced/12_Administrative-Changes-After-1858.md. **Study link:** ANALYSIS: Post-1947 integration and boundary challenges -> advanced/28_Integration-of-Princely-States.md.

4. Must-Know Facts (Prelims)

- FACT: **First Anglo-Afghan War (1839-42)** is associated with Auckland and the disastrous Kabul retreat.
- FACT: **Second Anglo-Afghan War (1878-80)** is associated with Lytton and the **Treaty of Gandamak**.
- FACT: **Durand Line (1893)** concerns Afghanistan, not Tibet or Burma.
- FACT: **First Anglo-Burmese War (1824-26)** ended with **Treaty of Yandabo**.
- FACT: **Third Anglo-Burmese War (1885)** annexed Upper Burma under Dufferin.
- FACT: **Treaty of Sagauli (1816)** followed the Anglo-Nepalese War and enabled Gurkha recruitment.
- FACT: **Younghusband Mission (1904)** is linked to Tibet and Curzon.

5. UPSC Traps

MEMORY: Trap: Frontier policy is not only military history; connect it to **imperial geopolitics, buffer states and boundary legacies**.

- **WRONG:** The Great Game was mainly about Burma. -> It chiefly concerned Russian-British rivalry in Central Asia and Afghanistan.
- **WRONG:** Forward policy always meant annexation. -> It could mean influence, missions, subsidies, frontier posts or control of external relations.
- **WRONG:** Nepal was annexed like Burma. -> Nepal remained a buffer state after Sagauli.
- **WRONG:** The McMahon Line belongs to this same early Afghan frontier context. -> It is a later Tibetan frontier issue; do not mix it with the **Durand Line (1893)**.

6. CURRENT: Current link

- **ANALYSIS:** **Afghanistan instability, Myanmar border issues and Himalayan strategic debates**. Colonial frontier-making helps explain the historical depth of India's neighbourhood security concerns. (*Escalate to CURRENT: when pegged to a verified news item.*)

7. Mains angles

- ANALYSIS: GS-1: Analyse the Great Game as the geopolitical background to British policy towards Afghanistan.
- ANALYSIS: GS-1: Compare annexation in Burma with buffer-state policy in Nepal and Afghanistan.
- ANALYSIS: GS-1: Discuss how frontier policies combined commercial motives, military security and imperial prestige.
- ANALYSIS: GS-1: Evaluate the post-colonial legacy of colonial boundary-making in South Asia.

CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES

COMPLETE TOPIC ASCII MASTER FLOW DIAGRAM

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 1/12: Imperial defensive ring in colonial frontier policy

FOCUS -> Imperial defensive ring

EVIDENCE -> British India treated neighbouring states and frontier zones as a strategic ring around the Indian empire.

EXAM USE -> use Imperial defensive ring to match actor, date, mechanism and limit.

LIMIT -> do not transfer Imperial defensive ring to another institution or theatre.

MUST REMEMBER: Keep the Afghan wars (1839-42, 1878-80, 1919), Burma wars (1824-26, 1852, 1885), Nepal war and Treaty of Sugauli (1814-16), and Younghusband mission to Tibet (1903-04) distinct.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 2/12: Great Game in colonial frontier policy

FOCUS -> Great Game

EVIDENCE -> The Great Game describes Anglo-Russian rivalry in Central Asia that shaped British policy toward Afghanistan.

EXAM USE -> use Great Game to match actor, date, mechanism and limit.

LIMIT -> do not transfer Great Game to another institution or theatre.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 3/12: Close-border policy in colonial frontier policy

FOCUS -> Close-border policy

EVIDENCE -> Close-border policy sought to defend settled limits without permanent advance into tribal or Afghan territory.

EXAM USE -> use Close-border policy to match actor, date, mechanism and limit.

LIMIT -> do not transfer Close-border policy to another institution or theatre.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 4/12: Forward policy in colonial frontier policy

FOCUS -> Forward policy

EVIDENCE -> Forward policy used missions, posts, subsidies, war and political control to pre-empt perceived rival influence.

EXAM USE -> use Forward policy to match actor, date, mechanism and limit.

LIMIT -> do not transfer Forward policy to another institution or theatre.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 5/12: First Anglo-Afghan War in colonial frontier policy

FOCUS -> First Anglo-Afghan War

EVIDENCE -> The First Anglo-Afghan War of 1839-42 ended in a disastrous British retreat from Kabul.

EXAM USE -> use First Anglo-Afghan War to match actor, date, mechanism and limit.

LIMIT -> do not transfer First Anglo-Afghan War to another institution or theatre.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 6/12: Second Anglo-Afghan War in colonial frontier policy

FOCUS -> Second Anglo-Afghan War

EVIDENCE -> The Second Anglo-Afghan War of 1878-80 reflected Lytton's forward policy.

EXAM USE -> use Second Anglo-Afghan War to match actor, date, mechanism and limit.

LIMIT -> do not transfer Second Anglo-Afghan War to another institution or theatre.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 7/12: Treaty of Gandamak in colonial frontier policy

FOCUS -> Treaty of Gandamak

EVIDENCE -> The Treaty of Gandamak of 1879 followed the Second Anglo-Afghan War and expanded British influence over Afghan external affairs.

EXAM USE -> use Treaty of Gandamak to match actor, date, mechanism and limit.

LIMIT -> do not transfer Treaty of Gandamak to another institution or theatre.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 8/12: Durand Line in colonial frontier policy

FOCUS -> Durand Line

EVIDENCE -> The Durand agreement of 1893 marked the Afghan frontier sphere under colonial strategic pressure.

EXAM USE -> use Durand Line to match actor, date, mechanism and limit.

LIMIT -> do not transfer Durand Line to another institution or theatre.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 9/12: North-West Frontier Province in colonial frontier policy

FOCUS -> North-West Frontier Province

EVIDENCE -> Curzon created the North-West Frontier Province in 1901 as a special frontier administration.

EXAM USE -> use North-West Frontier Province to match actor, date, mechanism and limit.

LIMIT -> do not transfer North-West Frontier Province to another institution or theatre.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 10/12: First Anglo-Burmese War in colonial frontier policy

FOCUS -> First Anglo-Burmese War

EVIDENCE -> The First Anglo-Burmese War of 1824-26 ended with the Treaty of Yandabo.

EXAM USE -> use First Anglo-Burmese War to match actor, date, mechanism and limit.

LIMIT -> do not transfer First Anglo-Burmese War to another institution or theatre.

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Forward policy, 'masterly inactivity', buffer strategy, annexation and frontier administration were debated and changed over time; modern boundaries cannot be projected backward.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 11/12: Second Anglo-Burmese War in colonial frontier policy

FOCUS -> Second Anglo-Burmese War

EVIDENCE -> The Second Anglo-Burmese War of 1852 led to the annexation of Lower Burma under Dalhousie.

EXAM USE -> use Second Anglo-Burmese War to match actor, date, mechanism and limit.

LIMIT -> do not transfer Second Anglo-Burmese War to another institution or theatre.

EVIDENCE LIMIT: Imperial strategic writing must be checked against treaty texts, terrain, logistics and Afghan, Burmese, Nepali, Tibetan and frontier agency rather than reproducing a Great Game gaze.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 12/12: Third Anglo-Burmese War in colonial frontier policy

FOCUS -> Third Anglo-Burmese War

EVIDENCE -> The Third Anglo-Burmese War of 1885 led to the annexation of Upper Burma under Dufferin.

EXAM USE -> use Third Anglo-Burmese War to match actor, date, mechanism and limit.

LIMIT -> do not transfer Third Anglo-Burmese War to another institution or theatre.